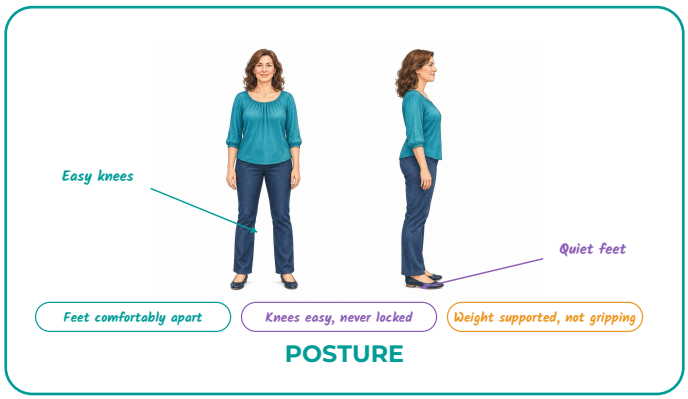
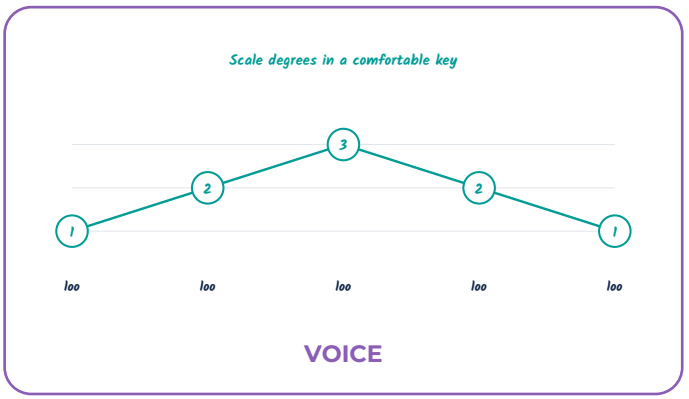
DIRECTOR'S RESOURCE COLLECTION

120 READY-TO-USE ACTIVITIES

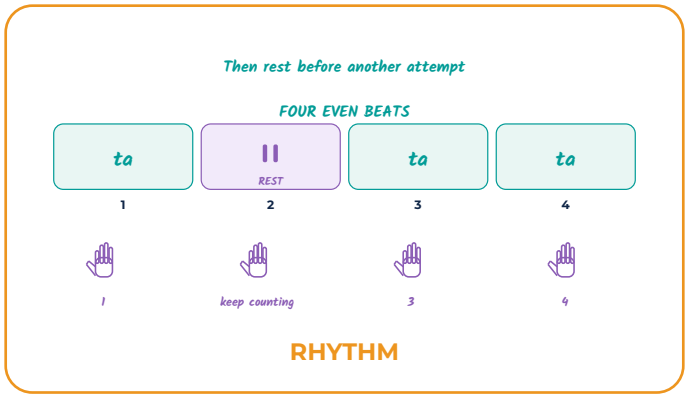
An illustrated practical collection for church, children's, youth, adult, and community choirs.



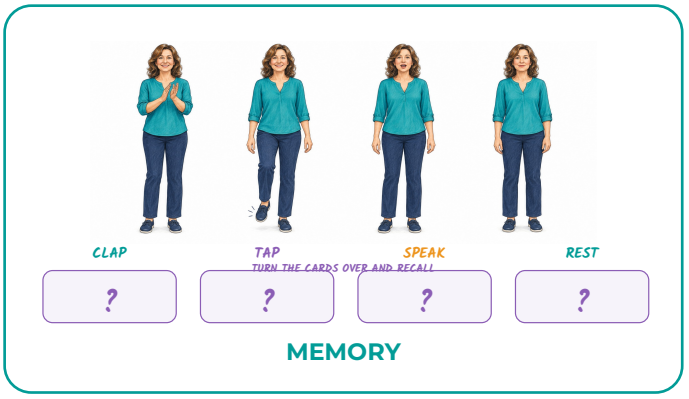
POSTURE



VOICE



RHYTHM



MEMORY

Illustrated methods you can understand, try, and use in real music.

Start with one useful change

Choose a purpose

Pick the category that matches today's need. Select one activity, read its goal, and prepare any listed materials. A complete rehearsal does not need all twelve categories.

Lead the three steps

Model first, let the choir respond, and pause between attempts. The minutes shown are approximate teaching time, including explanation and recovery. Never repeat a vocal pattern continuously for the whole block.

Check what changed

Use the Look / Listen For box to evaluate one observable result. If it has not happened, simplify the task or model it again. Transfer the useful skill into a real phrase before moving on.

Adapt the task

The Make It Work box offers a practical adjustment. Seated participation, speaking, a different octave, listening, or a shorter pattern may be appropriate. Choose material and language suited to the group.

Use the library

Activities are numbered 001–120. Each category contains ten. The members area includes individual pages, category collections, high-resolution PNG previews, and optional completion marks stored on the current device.

Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

Patterns, pacing, and voice care

Read the note numbers

Number patterns refer to scale degrees in a comfortable major key: 1 is home, then 2, 3, 4, and 5 ascend by steps in that key. The numbers are not fixed pitches. Set a suitable starting note with a keyboard or a reliable model. Singers may use an appropriate octave.

Use the rhythm words

In a simple beat, ta is one sound per beat; ti-ti is two equal sounds inside a beat. A rest means silence while the pulse continues. Introduce patterns in speech before combining rhythm and notes.

Keep the work comfortable

Use modest range and volume. Offer smaller patterns, speech, or listening. Breaths are ordinary and unforced; no breath holding, maximum inhalation, or longest-breath contests are needed. Rest between attempts.

Know when to pause

Stop an exercise that causes pain, dizziness, or strain. Do not press singers to sing while hoarse or tired. Persistent voice concerns need appropriate professional advice. These are educational rehearsal activities, not voice treatment.

Respect people and music

Solo demonstrations, touch, personal disclosure, and recording are optional and require appropriate permission. Use repertoire you are entitled to reproduce or arrange. The short example words and patterns in this collection are original teaching examples.

Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

Your twelve categories

01 Body Preparation & Posture

Activities 001-010. Find support, release extra effort, and see the cue.

02 Breathing & Airflow Control

Activities 011-020. Plan comfortable breaths that serve the phrase.

03 Vocal Warm-Ups

Activities 021-030. Build easy coordination and connect it to real music.

04 Diction & Articulation

Activities 031-040. Make every word clear without unnecessary tension.

05 Rhythm & Pulse

Activities 041-050. Keep the beat, place the rhythm, and use silence.

06 Connection & Confidence

Activities 051-060. Create a welcoming choir that listens and participates.

Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

Your twelve categories

07 Pitch & Listening

Activities 061-070. Hear, remember, and coordinate comfortable pitches.

08 Focus & Memory

Activities 071-080. Keep track of cues, words, patterns, and landmarks.

09 Expression & Interpretation

Activities 081-090. Let musical choices communicate the text.

10 Rehearsal & Teamwork

Activities 091-100. Give practice a clear purpose and a useful next step.

11 Performance Preparation

Activities 101-110. Prepare the cues, space, sequence, and recovery plan.

12 Creativity & Inspiration

Activities 111-120. Create bounded musical ideas with a practical purpose.

Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

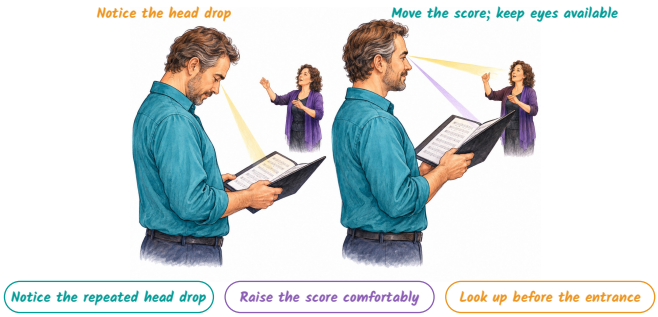
MODULE 01

Body Preparation & Posture

Find support, release extra effort, and see the cue.



Balanced Feet



Score at Eye Level

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

1. Balanced Feet
2. Shoulder Elevator
3. Jaw Rest Check
4. Seated Singer Setup
5. Score at Eye Level
6. Space Between Singers
7. Slow Body Scan
8. Hands Without Grip
9. Turn Toward the Cue
10. Posture Reset Signal

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 001

Balanced Feet

Body Preparation & Posture

3 minutes / Standing space or a firm chair.

Find a stable stance without locking the knees.



Feet comfortably apart

Knees easy, never locked

Weight supported, not gripping

Front and side views of a supported singing stance.

1

Place feet comfortably apart and soften the knees; seated singers rest both feet on a stable support.

2

Shift weight gently forward and back, then settle where neither heels nor toes grip.

3

Speak one short lyric line, then sing it on a comfortable note without changing the easy stance.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Feet remain quiet and the first sung phrase feels as easy as speaking.

COMMON TRAP

Locking the knees to look upright.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the whole activity seated; use small weight shifts instead of standing.

ACTIVITY 002

Shoulder Elevator

Body Preparation & Posture

3 minutes / No equipment.

Release unnecessary shoulder lifting before a phrase.

small lift

release



A small shoulder lift

Let the shoulders settle

Hum without another shrug

Lift a little, release, then keep the easy position.

1. *Lift both shoulders a small, comfortable amount and let them settle; repeat three times without rolling the neck.*
2. *Take an ordinary quiet breath while a partner observes whether the shoulders stay easy.*
3. *Sing a four-beat hum, rest, and repeat three times while keeping the shoulders settled.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers start the hum without a visible shoulder shrug.

COMMON TRAP

Rolling or forcing the neck while lifting the shoulders.

MAKE IT WORK

Observe your own shoulders in a mirror instead of working with a partner.

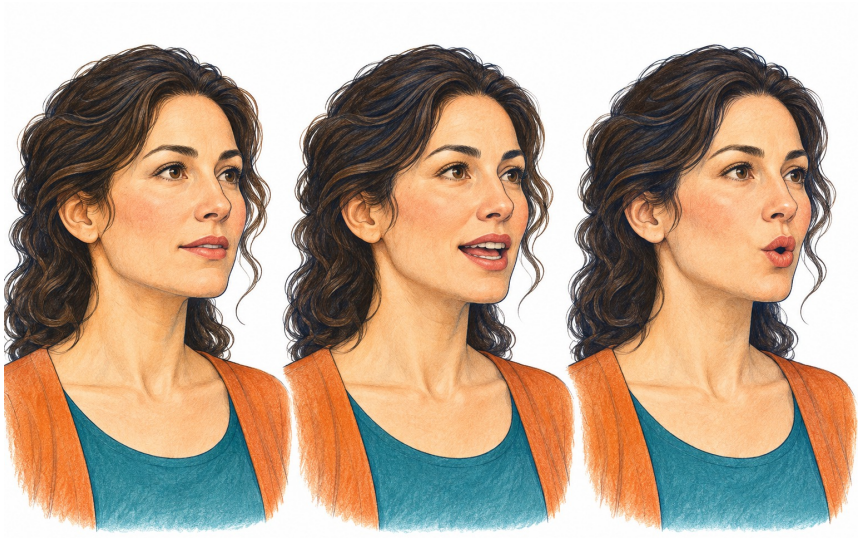
ACTIVITY 003

Jaw Rest Check

Body Preparation & Posture

3 minutes / A short familiar lyric.

Notice jaw clenching and return to an easy speaking position.



Unclench | Speak an easy "yeah" | Sing a small "oo"

Natural movement: no pulling, stretching, or forcing the jaw.

1. Let the lips part naturally, keeping teeth unclenched; do not pull the jaw open.
2. Say 'yeah, yeah, yeah' gently as in friendly conversation, then speak the lyric.
3. Sing the lyric on one comfortable note; pause and reset if the jaw begins to brace.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Words stay understandable without exaggerated mouth opening.

COMMON TRAP

Pulling the jaw open with the hands.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 'hello' instead of 'yeah'; no touching or jaw manipulation is needed.

ACTIVITY 004

Seated Singer Setup

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / Stable chairs without wheels.

Keep a useful singing position when standing is not practical.



Feet supported

Use a stable chair

See the director without craning

Comfort and a clear sightline matter more than a rigid pose.

1

Sit where the pelvis feels supported, with feet supported and room for the arms; do not force a rigid upright pose.

2

Look ahead at an imaginary director and breathe normally for two cycles.

3

Sing two short phrases, resting between them; adjust the chair or score height if the chin lifts.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Eyes can reach the director without craning the neck.

COMMON TRAP

Forcing every singer to sit at the front edge.

MAKE IT WORK

Use back support whenever needed; the goal is comfort, not sitting at the chair edge.

ACTIVITY 005

Score at Eye Level

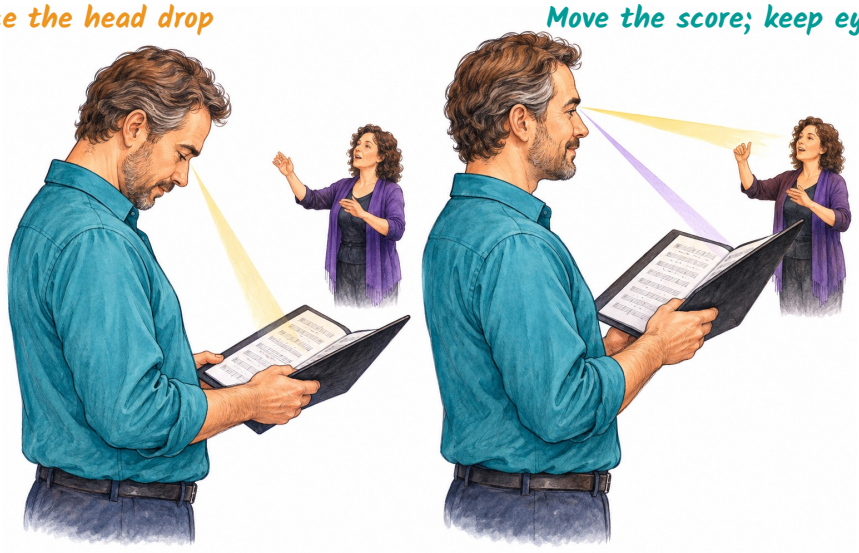
Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / A score or one lyric sheet.

Reduce repeated head dropping while reading music.

Notice the head drop

Move the score; keep eyes available



Notice the repeated head drop

Raise the score comfortably

Look up before the entrance

Move the score into a useful place; keep the elbows easy.

1. Hold the score so both music and director are visible; keep elbows comfortable.

2. Alternate looking at the first word and the director's hand for four silent cues.

3. Sing the opening phrase, looking up before the entrance rather than after it begins.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Most singers see the preparation gesture before making sound.

COMMON TRAP

Raising the chin instead of moving the score.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a music stand, large print, or a memorized line if holding paper is difficult.

ACTIVITY 006

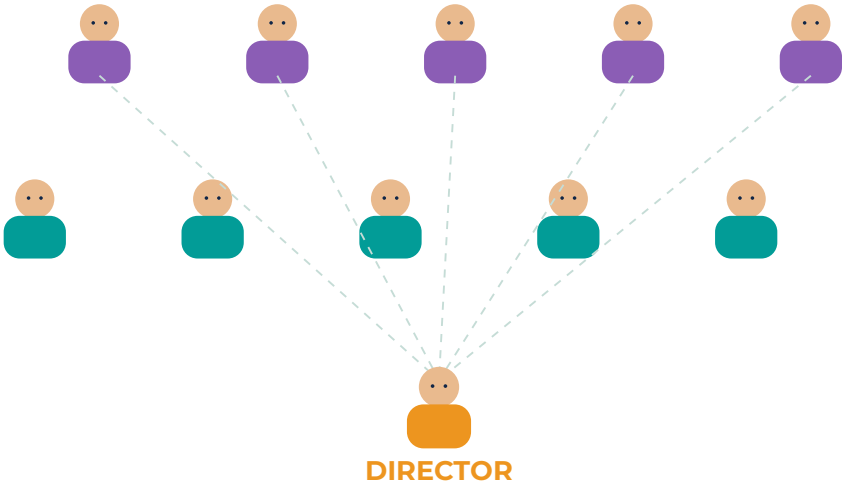
Space Between Singers

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / Rehearsal formation.

Create enough room for comfortable movement and sightlines.

Clear gaps through the front row



Stagger the back row so every singer can see the director.

1. Invite singers to check personal space without touching anyone; arms can remain by their sides.
2. Adjust rows so each singer sees the director through a clear gap.
3. Sing a short passage, then ask whether anyone is leaning around a neighbour; make one practical adjustment.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

No singer must lean or twist to see the beat.

COMMON TRAP

Creating neat rows that block someone's view.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep mobility aids in place and change the formation around access needs.

ACTIVITY 007

Slow Body Scan

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / Quiet rehearsal space.

Identify one unnecessary area of tension before singing.



Notice in this order. Change only what feels useful.

1. *Pause and notice feet, knees, shoulders, hands, and face in that order; change only what feels comfortable.*

2. *Uncurl fingers and release a clenched face while breathing normally.*

3. *Sing a gentle three-note pattern, then name one physical change that made the task easier.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers can name a specific helpful adjustment without being told to 'relax everything'.

COMMON TRAP

Trying to release every muscle at once.

MAKE IT WORK

Offer a silent observation option; no one needs to explain personal sensations to the group.

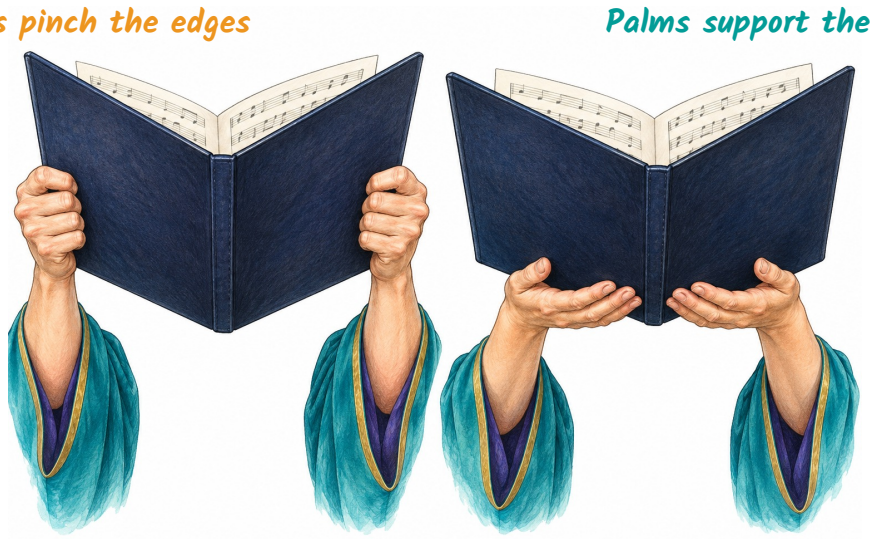
ACTIVITY 008

Hands Without Grip

Body Preparation & Posture

3 minutes / A light score or folder.

Stop score gripping from spreading effort into the upper body.



Notice fingertip pressure

Support the weight underneath

Keep the folder secure and light

A secure folder does not require a hard pinch.

1. Hold the folder normally, then briefly notice thumb and finger pressure.
2. Support its weight with the palms or a stand so the fingertips do less work.
3. Alternate two spoken lines and two sung lines while maintaining the lighter hold.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The folder stays secure without white knuckles or raised shoulders.

COMMON TRAP

Replacing a hard grip with an insecure hold.

MAKE IT WORK

Place materials on a stand or lap and follow from there.

ACTIVITY 009

Turn Toward the Cue

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / Two possible conductor positions.

Coordinate a small body turn without twisting the neck.



Find the main cue

Turn the body a little

Keep head and torso aligned

Let the whole body face the cue rather than twisting the neck.

1

Begin facing the main director and notice where the feet or chair point.

2

Move the whole body a little toward a side leader rather than turning only the head.

3

Follow four alternating silent cues, then repeat with a two-note sung response.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Eyes reach the cue comfortably with no prolonged neck twist.

COMMON TRAP

Turning only the head and holding the twist.

MAKE IT WORK

Seated singers can reposition the chair before starting or follow only the main director.

ACTIVITY 010

Posture Reset Signal

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / One agreed open-hand signal.

Build a quick, nonverbal reset into a busy rehearsal.

OPEN PALM

Pause the phrase

RELEASE EFFORT

Find easy support

READY

Watch the next preparation



Agree the signal first; allow an ordinary breath before restarting.

1. Agree that an open palm means pause, release unnecessary effort, and find support.
2. Rehearse a short phrase; show the signal between repetitions and allow one ordinary breath.
3. Repeat the phrase and ask the choir to notice one improvement in readiness, not appearance.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group returns to readiness without a long verbal explanation.

COMMON TRAP

Using a reset signal before agreeing its meaning.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a spoken 'reset' alongside the gesture for singers who cannot see it clearly.

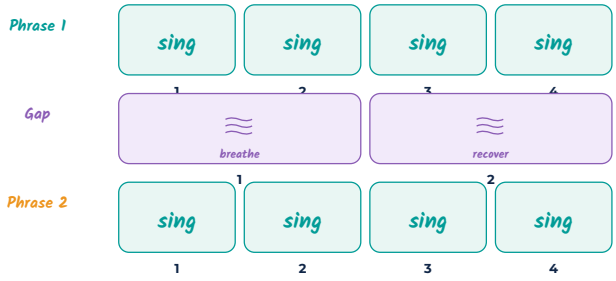
MODULE 02

Breathing & Airflow Control

Plan comfortable breaths that serve the phrase.



Quiet Arrival Breath



Release and Refill

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

11 Quiet Arrival Breath

12 Four-Beat Air Ribbon

13 Breath Mark Detective

14 Prepare on the Gesture

15 Release and Refill

16 Staggered Breath Teams

17 Airflow Traffic Lights

18 Consonant Air Budget

19 Two-Phrase Breath Map

20 Unhurried Final Release

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 011

Quiet Arrival Breath

Breathing & Airflow Control

3 minutes / No equipment.

Replace a rushed gasp with an unforced inhalation.



A quiet, modest breath

Shoulders stay easy

Speak your greeting

The flower is an image for ease, never a reason to inhale more.

1. Stand or sit comfortably and take two ordinary breaths without changing them.
2. Imagine smelling a mild flower; allow a quiet, modest inhalation, then release it normally.
3. Speak a four-word greeting and repeat after the same easy preparation; rest between attempts.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The greeting begins without an audible gasp or lifted shoulders.

COMMON TRAP

Taking a maximum breath to copy the flower image.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep breaths completely natural if imagery encourages over-inhaling.

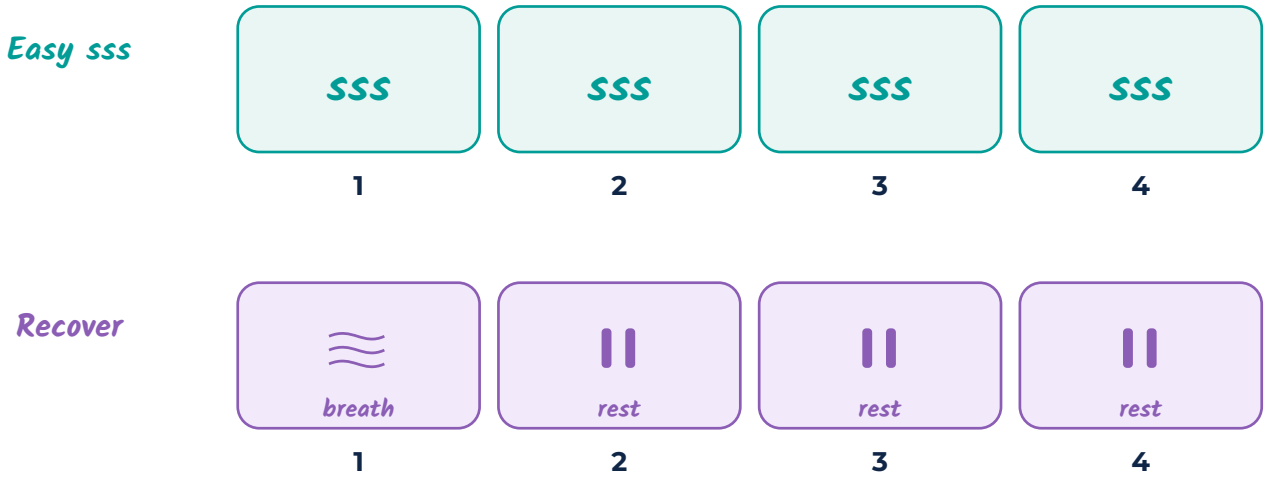
ACTIVITY 012

Four-Beat Air Ribbon

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / A slow four-beat count.

Release air evenly for a short musical phrase.



One even four-beat release, then normal breathing before another attempt.

1. Inhale comfortably without filling to the maximum; release an easy 'sss' over four steady beats.
2. Rest for at least one normal breath before repeating three times.
3. Sing a gentle four-beat note and compare the steadiness of its ending with the air-only version.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The air stream stays even and the ending does not collapse or squeeze.

COMMON TRAP

Turning the release into a longest-breath contest.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two beats if four is uncomfortable; never compete for the longest breath.

ACTIVITY 013

Breath Mark Detective

Breathing & Airflow Control

5 minutes / One printed or projected phrase.

Choose sensible breath locations in actual repertoire.

Complete thought		Complete thought	
Soft	stars	shine	tonight.
We	sing	as	one.

Original practice text: a breath between complete thoughts, never inside a word.

1. Read the text aloud and underline where its meaning naturally pauses.
2. Mark one shared breath location that respects both the words and the musical phrase.
3. Sing from just before that point twice, checking that the breath does not split a word or rush the next entry.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group can explain why its chosen breath supports the meaning.

COMMON TRAP

Choosing a breath that splits a word.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-line spoken poem before applying the idea to a score.

ACTIVITY 014

Prepare on the Gesture

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / Director and a short sung response.

Link an easy preparatory breath to the director's upbeat.



- Watch the preparation
- Breathe without holding
- "loo" on the downbeat

Respond to the gesture; do not guess how long the pause will last.

1. Show a silent preparation gesture and let the group breathe naturally with it; avoid breath holding.
2. Add a comfortable 'loo' on the next downbeat for two beats.
3. Vary the pause before preparation so singers respond to the gesture instead of guessing the timing.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Entrances occur together after the preparation, without a premature gasp.

COMMON TRAP

Holding the breath after the preparation.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a larger gesture and spoken count before removing the count.

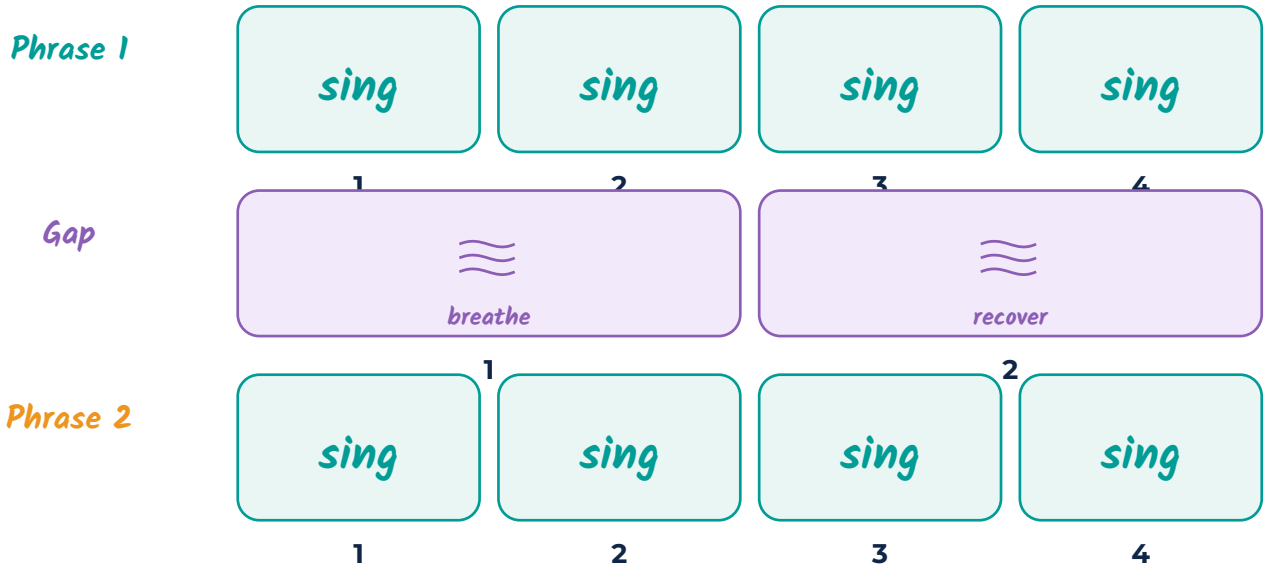
ACTIVITY 015

Release and Refill

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / Two four-beat phrases.

Recover comfortably between two short phrases.



Keep the two-beat gap available for an unforced recovery breath.

1. *Sing one easy four-beat phrase, then release the last sound cleanly.*
2. *Allow an unforced breath during a clear two-beat gap; keep the throat free rather than holding the air.*
3. *Sing the second phrase and repeat the pair at a pace that leaves enough recovery time.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The second phrase begins as comfortably as the first.

COMMON TRAP

Making the recovery gap too short for the group.

MAKE IT WORK

Extend the gap to four beats; shorten phrases for younger or less experienced groups.

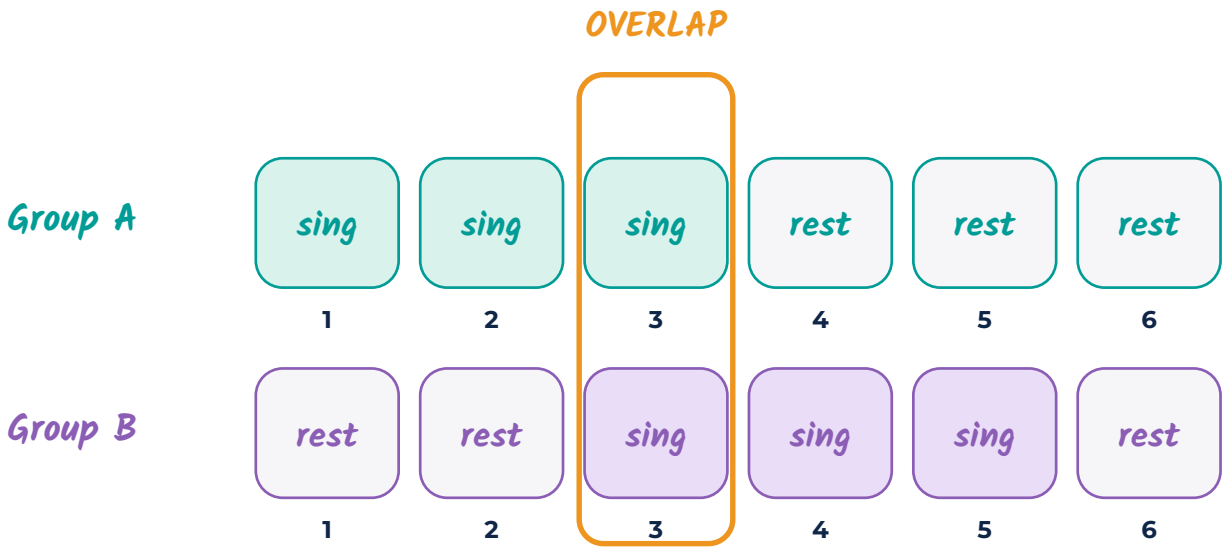
ACTIVITY 016

Staggered Breath Teams

Breathing & Airflow Control

6 minutes / Two groups and a comfortable shared note.

Maintain a sustained ensemble sound without individual breath contests.



Overlap on beat 3. The resting group breathes normally; nobody competes for duration.

1. Group A sings gently for three beats while B rests, then B takes over before A stops.
2. Repeat with a one-beat overlap, letting each singer take ordinary breaths in their rest time.
3. Move into a held chord from the repertoire and plan individual breaths away from the final release.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ensemble sound continues while individuals breathe without pressure.

COMMON TRAP

Asking one group to sustain beyond comfort.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep two clear teams until the continuous sound is stable.

ACTIVITY 017

Airflow Traffic Lights

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / Green and red cards, or two hand signs.

Connect preparation, sound, and release without holding the breath.



Easy four-beat sound

Release, then normal breathing

Red means recovery, not holding the air in silence.

1. Explain green as an easy four-beat sound and red as a release followed by normal breathing.
2. Alternate green and red while singers use a gentle 'vvv' or a voiced 'oo'.
3. After three cycles, transfer the same coordination to the first note of a song.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Red produces a clean release, not a tense suspended breath.

COMMON TRAP

Treating red as a tense breath hold.

MAKE IT WORK

Use only an ordinary spoken vowel if voiced fricatives feel awkward.

ACTIVITY 018

Consonant Air Budget

Breathing & Airflow Control

5 minutes / Phrase 'Soft stars shine tonight'.

Notice how repeated consonants affect a phrase.

Soft | stars | shine | tonight

Concise s / sh | Keep clear vowels | Finish the final word

Speak first, then use one note. Do not stretch the consonants.

1. Speak the phrase slowly and notice air escaping on 's' and 'sh'; do not exaggerate them.
2. Speak again with concise consonants and clear vowels on four beats.
3. Sing the words on one note, then on their melody, keeping room to finish the final word.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The final word remains clear without pushing to the end.

COMMON TRAP

Stretching every s and sh to sound clearer.

MAKE IT WORK

Choose a shorter phrase with fewer consonants if needed.

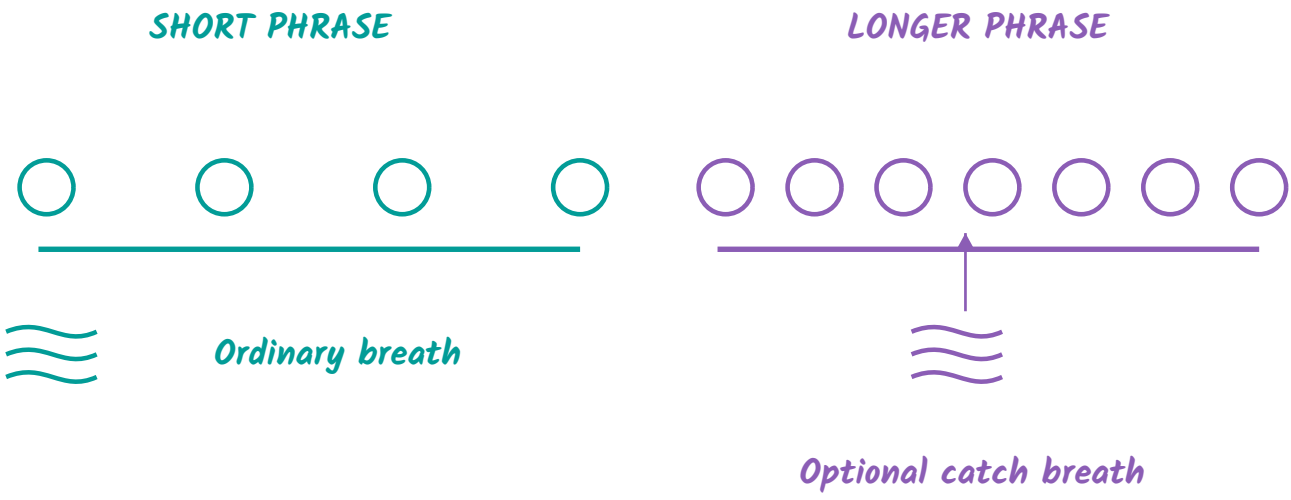
ACTIVITY 019

Two-Phrase Breath Map

Breathing & Airflow Control

6 minutes / Two contrasting phrases from a score.

Plan different breaths for short and longer musical ideas.



Choose a shorter unit when needed

Plan for the phrase you can sing comfortably; split a longer line when needed.

1. Speak both phrases and decide where each one should lead.
2. Rehearse the shorter phrase with an ordinary breath; rehearse the longer one at a manageable tempo with an optional marked catch breath.
3. Sing them in order and check whether the plan fits the group's current ability.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir uses a repeatable plan rather than running out of air unpredictably.

COMMON TRAP

Asking for more air instead of shortening the phrase.

MAKE IT WORK

Split the longer phrase instead of asking singers to inhale more forcefully.

ACTIVITY 020

Unhurried Final Release

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / One held note from repertoire.

Finish a note together while allowing an easy recovery.

Sustain

oo	oo	oo	release
1	2	3	4

Afterwards

normal	breathing
1	2

Watch the closing gesture on beat 4; let breathing return immediately.

1. Sing a comfortable note for three beats and watch a visible closing gesture on beat four.
2. Release the vowel and allow normal breathing immediately afterwards.
3. Repeat with a final consonant placed exactly at the release; compare the endings.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers stop together without squeezing the last moment or holding their breath afterwards.

COMMON TRAP

Squeezing the final moment before recovery.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-beat hold and no consonant first.

MODULE 03

Vocal Warm-Ups

Build easy coordination and connect it to real music.



Hum to Open Vowel



Vowel Colour Circle

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

21 *Hum to Open Vowel*

22 *Three-Note Neighbourhood*

23 *Gentle Descending Five*

24 *Small-Range Glide*

25 *Vowel Colour Circle*

26 *Soft 'V' Bridge*

27 *Legato Beads*

28 *Gentle Repeated Notes*

29 *Echo Then Choose*

30 *Warm-Up to Song*

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 021

Hum to Open Vowel

Vocal Warm-Ups

4 minutes / Comfortable starting pitch, optional keyboard.

Move from a gentle hum into an open vowel without a sudden volume jump.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

1. *Hum 'mm' softly for two beats with the jaw easy; rest after each attempt.*
2. *On the same note, open from 'mm' to 'oo' while keeping the sound unforced.*
3. *Repeat on 'oh' and apply the smooth transition to one lyric syllable.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

COMMON TRAP

Making the open vowel suddenly louder.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a gentle 'ng' only if it is familiar; otherwise stay with 'mm'.

ACTIVITY 022

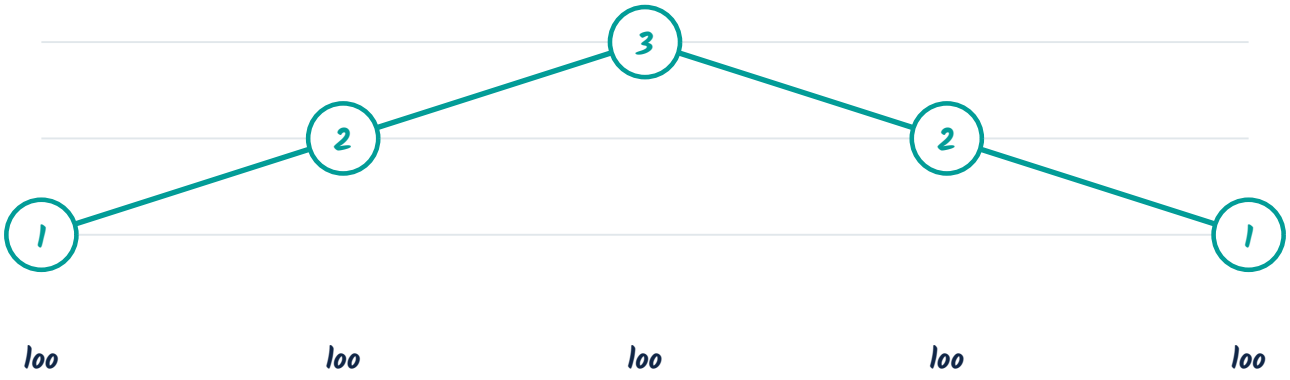
Three-Note Neighbourhood

Vocal Warm-Ups

4 minutes / A starting note matched to the group.

Coordinate a short stepwise pattern in a comfortable middle range.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



One note per beat. Keep the same comfortable key until it feels easy.

1

Model scale degrees 1-2-3-2-1 on 'loo', one note per beat; let singers listen once.

2

Echo twice, resting between attempts; keep the same key until it is comfortable.

3

Move the starting note only a small amount if the entire group remains at ease.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

COMMON TRAP

Transposing before the pattern is comfortable.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 1-2-1 or allow singers to listen instead of transposing.

ACTIVITY 023

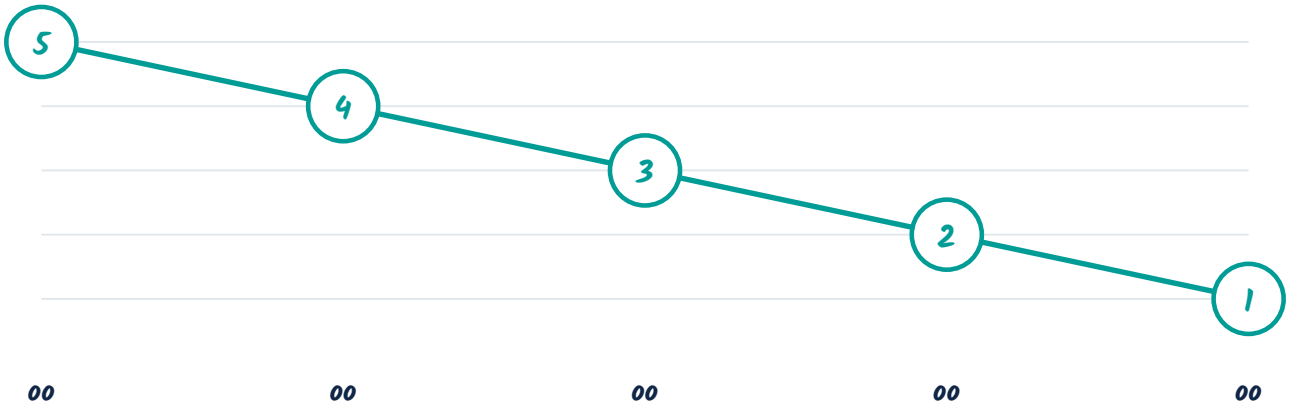
Gentle Descending Five

Vocal Warm-Ups

5 minutes / Optional keyboard for a suitable key.

Maintain an even vowel through a descending line.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



A gentle descent. Keep the final notes clear instead of pushing them down.

1. *Model 5-4-3-2-1 on 'oo' in a range already comfortable for the choir.*
2. *Echo the pattern slowly, resting after each repetition and keeping the last note audible.*
3. *Repeat on 'oh', then use the same easy descent in a short repertoire passage.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

COMMON TRAP

Pushing the low end of the descent.

MAKE IT WORK

Reduce to 3-2-1 for changing or uncertain voices.

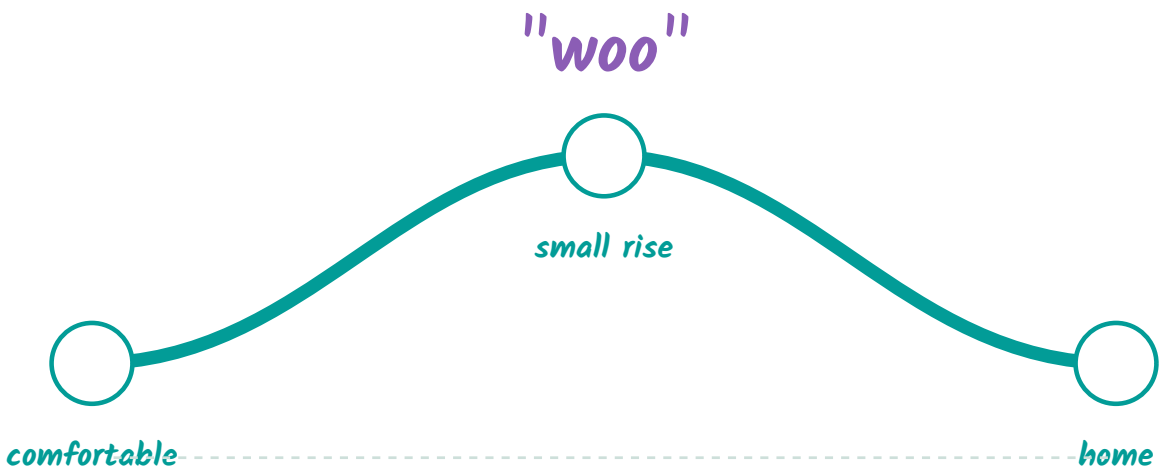
ACTIVITY 024

Small-Range Glide

Vocal Warm-Ups

3 minutes / No equipment.

Explore a connected sound within a modest, comfortable range.



A small, comfortable rise and return; this is not a range test.

1. Model a gentle 'woo' moving a small distance up and back down; avoid the extremes of your range.
2. Invite two brief echoes with an ordinary breath and rest between them.
3. Repeat once using a hand to trace the sound, then return to a single comfortable note.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The glide remains light and continuous rather than loud or stretched.

COMMON TRAP

Stretching the glide toward range extremes.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the exercise on one note if gliding encourages strain.

ACTIVITY 025

Vowel Colour Circle

Vocal Warm-Ups

5 minutes / A comfortable shared note.

Keep pitch steady while changing vowels.



oo — oh — ah

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

The mouth shape changes while pitch and volume stay reasonably steady.

1. Sing 'oo-oh-ah' on one note, changing vowel on each beat and releasing on beat four.
2. Listen for pitch drifting when the mouth shape changes; repeat gently at the same volume.
3. Reverse the order, then use the most stable vowel in one phrase from the music.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Vowel changes are audible while pitch and volume stay reasonably consistent.

COMMON TRAP

Changing pitch every time the vowel changes.

MAKE IT WORK

Use just 'oo-oh' for two beats with younger groups.

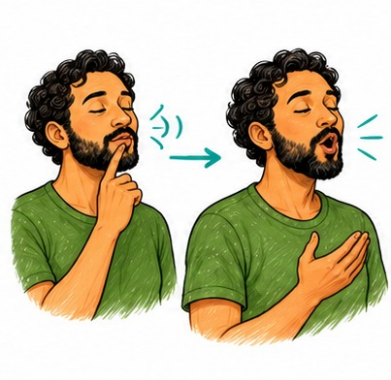
ACTIVITY 026

Soft 'V' Bridge

Vocal Warm-Ups

4 minutes / A comfortable speaking-range pitch.

Connect a voiced consonant to a clear vowel.



vvv → oo

continuous sound

Easy voiced start

Clear vowel

Keep the sound continuous across the change, then release and rest.

1. Model a gentle 'vvv-oo' for two beats, using little volume and no pressure at the lips.
2. Echo three times with rests, noticing the continuous sound between consonant and vowel.
3. Sing a short three-note descent using the same 'v' start.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The vowel begins smoothly rather than with an explosive onset.

COMMON TRAP

Pressing the lips to force a voiced v.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 'mm-oo' if a voiced 'v' is unfamiliar or uncomfortable.

ACTIVITY 027

Legato Beads

Vocal Warm-Ups

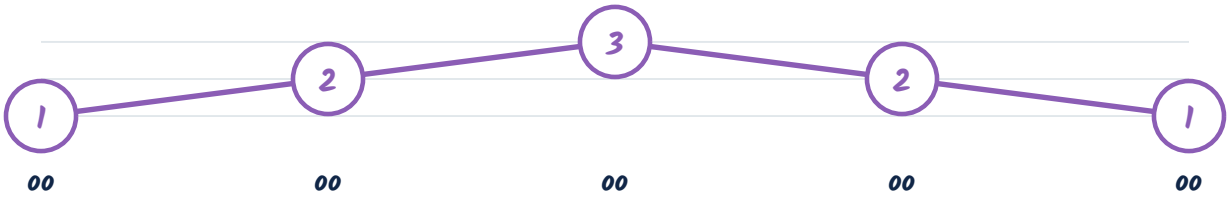
5 minutes / Pattern 1-2-3-2-1.

Join separate notes into one connected musical line.

SEPARATE SYLLABLES



ONE CONNECTED LINE



Same notes: compare separate "loo" syllables with one connected "oo".

1

Sing the pattern on separate 'loo' syllables to establish its notes.

2

Repeat on one continuous 'oo', imagining the notes as beads on the same thread.

3

Compare the two versions and transfer the connected version to a five-note phrase in repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The tone continues between notes without extra breaths or jaw pulses.

COMMON TRAP

Adding a jaw pulse or breath between every note.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the pattern to three notes and use a slower tempo.

ACTIVITY 028

Gentle Repeated Notes

Vocal Warm-Ups

4 minutes / A comfortable note and steady pulse.

Coordinate light repeated syllables without punching each onset.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS

noo	noo	noo	noo
1	2	3	4
1	2	3	4

Four light beginnings, followed by four silent recovery beats.

1. Speak 'noo, noo, noo, noo' conversationally on four beats.
2. Sing the four syllables on one note with small, easy beginnings; rest for four beats.
3. Compare a clear version with an unnecessarily heavy version demonstrated only in speech, then choose the easier sung response.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Each syllable is clear without a hard attack or extra volume.

COMMON TRAP

Punching every repeated onset.

MAKE IT WORK

Sing two syllables per turn and listen for ease rather than speed.

ACTIVITY 029

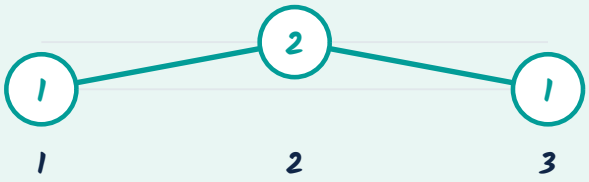
Echo Then Choose

Vocal Warm-Ups

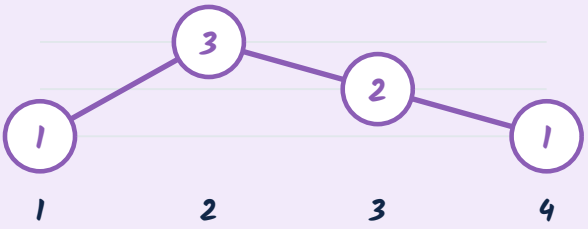
5 minutes / Two short patterns: 1-2-1 and 1-3-2-1.

Help singers select a comfortable warm-up option.

SHORTER



LONGER



Either choice can be useful

Listen to both. Choose an easy range, a different octave, or a listening turn.

1. *Model both patterns on 'mee' and have everyone listen before singing.*
2. *Let each singer choose the shorter or longer pattern while staying within their own comfortable range.*
3. *Alternate group responses, then ask which option prepared them best for today's music.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Choice improves participation without pressuring anyone to attempt an unsuitable range.

COMMON TRAP

Making the longer option a public achievement test.

MAKE IT WORK

Sing the chosen pattern in a different octave or listen if neither option feels easy.

ACTIVITY 030

Warm-Up to Song

Vocal Warm-Ups

6 minutes / A short phrase containing a three-note rise.

Connect a technical exercise to a real musical task.

1 / 2 / 3

Gentle "oo" pattern

VOWELS

Keep the actual rhythm

REAL WORDS

Restore concise consonants

A warm-up earns its place when it helps a real phrase.

1. Isolate the three-note rise and sing it gently on 'oo' at a comfortable pitch.
2. Add the actual vowels of the text, then its consonants without changing the musical shape.
3. Sing the full phrase and identify whether the exercise solved the original difficulty.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The full phrase improves in the specific way rehearsed, not just in general enthusiasm.

COMMON TRAP

Completing a warm-up without testing its transfer.

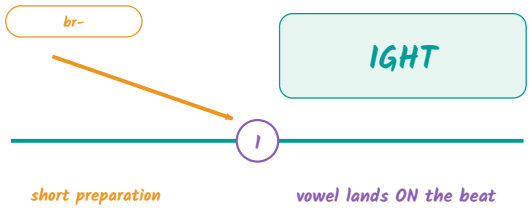
MAKE IT WORK

Slow the phrase or separate its rhythm from its pitches before combining them.

MODULE 04

Diction & Articulation

Make every word clear without unnecessary tension.





Consonant Launch Pad

One Word, Three Vowels

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

31 Consonant Launch Pad

32 Final Consonant Appointment

33 Vowel-Only Text

34 Slow-Speech Precision

35 One Word, Three Vowels

36 Syllable Train

37 Gentle Tongue Twister

38 Diphthong Landing

39 Word Stress Compass

40 Text Relay Without Blur

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

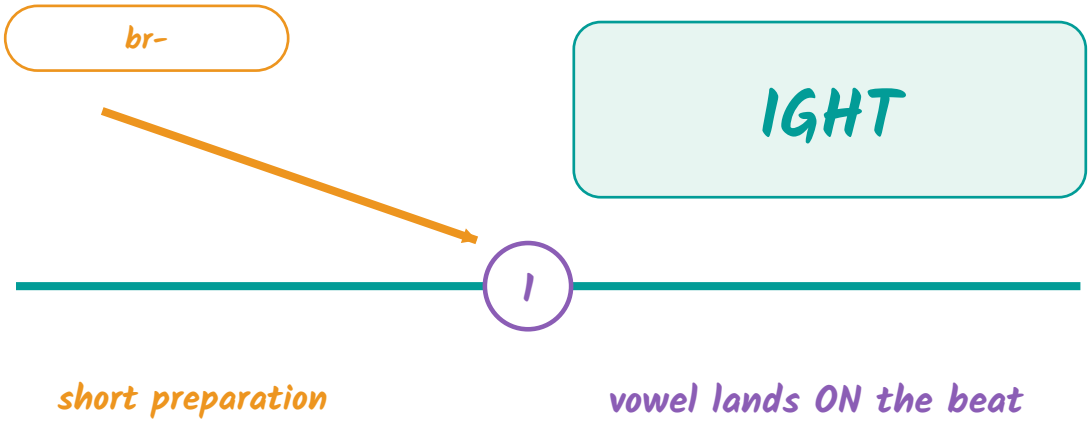
ACTIVITY 031

Consonant Launch Pad

Diction & Articulation

4 minutes / Text 'Bright morning, clear sky'.

Place an initial consonant just before the shared vowel.



The consonant prepares the word; the vowel meets the shared beat.

1. Speak the text on four beats, noticing the short consonant before each vowel.
2. Agree that the vowel lands on the beat; rehearse the opening word with a visible preparation.
3. Sing the whole line on one note, then in repertoire, keeping consonants concise rather than louder.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The first vowel arrives together while the word remains recognizable.

COMMON TRAP

Putting the consonant and vowel both after the beat.

MAKE IT WORK

Start with 'moon' and 'light' before using consonant clusters.

ACTIVITY 032

Final Consonant Appointment

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / Words ending in t, k, or s.

Agree exactly when a final consonant will be heard.

	1	2	3	4
"light"	lah	ah	ah	t
"look"	loo	oo	oo	k
"peace"	pee	ee	ee	s

Hold the vowel through beat 3; agree one final-consonant event on beat 4.

1. Sing 'light' on a comfortable note for three beats and place its final 't' on beat four.
2. Repeat with 'look' and 'peace', keeping the vowel alive until the agreed release.
3. Mark the same decision in one real phrase and rehearse only its last two words.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

There is one clear consonant event rather than several scattered endings.

COMMON TRAP

Releasing the vowel before the agreed consonant.

MAKE IT WORK

Use one final consonant at a time and exaggerate timing in speech first.

ACTIVITY 033

Vowel-Only Text

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / One familiar lyric line.

Reveal the vowel line hidden inside a lyric.

WORDS	Bright	morning	clear	sky
VOWELS	ai	or – i	ear	ai
WORDS	Bright	morning	clear	sky

A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

1. Speak the words naturally, then identify the main vowel in each syllable.
2. Sing the phrase using only those vowels, keeping its original rhythm and pitch.
3. Restore the consonants without breaking the connected vowel line; compare before and after.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

COMMON TRAP

Breaking the phrase when the consonants return.

MAKE IT WORK

Work with two words at a time and let the director model the vowels.

ACTIVITY 034

Slow-Speech Precision

Diction & Articulation

4 minutes / Sentence 'Many bright voices sing together'.

Clarify text without tightening the mouth or speeding up.

Ma-ny | bright | voi-ces | sing | to-ge-t her

Speak slowly | Clarify two words | Reconnect the sentence

Keep a conversational volume. Choose clarity rather than extra mouth effort.

1. Speak the sentence slowly at a comfortable conversational volume.
2. Choose the two least clear words and practise their syllables separately, using only necessary movement.
3. Speak the complete sentence in rhythm, then sing it once on a shared note.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listeners can identify every word without the speaker increasing volume.

COMMON TRAP

Using extra volume to hide unclear speech.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a shorter sentence or show written words while speaking.

ACTIVITY 035

One Word, Three Vowels

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / A word from current repertoire.

Agree a shared vowel shape for one problematic word.

LISTEN

Hear three relaxed versions

AGREE

Choose a version for this song

SING

Use it in the complete phrase

Listen respectfully; do not mock accents or guess an unfamiliar language.

1. Invite three relaxed spoken examples of the word; listen for differences in its vowel.
2. Choose the version that best fits the song's language and style without mocking accents.
3. Sing the word together at low volume and put it back into the phrase.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ensemble agrees on a repeatable vowel while retaining understandable language.

COMMON TRAP

Judging accents instead of choosing a shared version.

MAKE IT WORK

Ask a fluent speaker or language coach when pronunciation is unfamiliar.

ACTIVITY 036

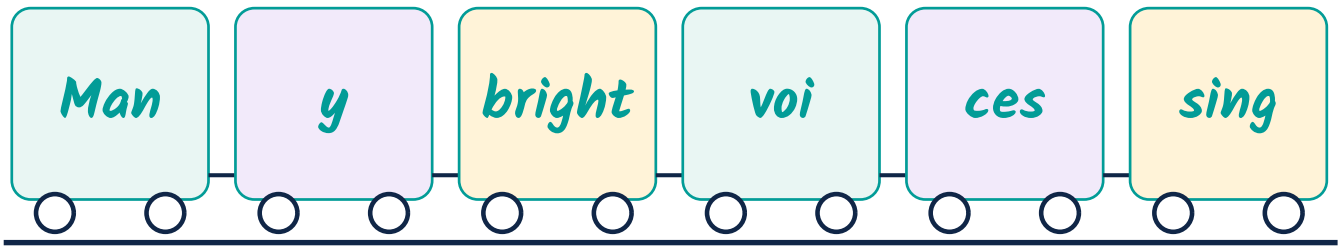
Syllable Train

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / One line with six to ten syllables.

Align syllables in a quick text passage.

SYLLABLES / WORDS / PHRASE



Six syllable cars. Reconnect them into words before adding pitches.

1. Write a slash between syllables and speak each one over a slow steady pulse.
2. Group the syllables into meaningful words while keeping their places in the rhythm.
3. Add pitches only after the spoken sequence is reliable; increase speed in small steps.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

No syllable disappears when the music returns.

COMMON TRAP

Increasing speed while syllables still disappear.

MAKE IT WORK

Stay at the spoken stage or reduce the passage to its first four syllables.

ACTIVITY 037

Gentle Tongue Twister

Diction & Articulation

4 minutes / Text 'Red ribbon, blue ribbon'.

Practise flexible consonants without a speed contest.

Red	rib-bon
Blue	rib-bon

Original practice text. Alternate the two phrases over a steady pulse.

1. Speak the two phrases slowly with an easy jaw and clear word boundaries.
2. Alternate them on four beats, pausing for a normal breath after each pair.
3. Sing the words on 1-2-3-2-1, allowing one syllable to cover more than one note if needed.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Clarity survives without jaw tightening or racing.

COMMON TRAP

Turning clarity practice into a speed contest.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 'red, blue' alone and let singers choose a slower pace.

ACTIVITY 038

Diphthong Landing

Diction & Articulation

6 minutes / Word 'day' or another song word.

Coordinate a moving vowel in a sustained English word.

"day"

daa	aa	aa	y
1	2	3	4

Keep the main vowel through beats 1–3. Let the vowel ending arrive near beat 4.

1. Speak 'day' and notice that its vowel changes near the end.
2. Sing the first part of the vowel for three beats, moving gently to its ending on beat four.
3. Apply that timing to the actual phrase, then adjust it to the music's style and duration.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The vowel change happens together instead of early in some voices.

COMMON TRAP

Moving to the vowel ending too early.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-beat word and demonstrate before asking for a response.

ACTIVITY 039

Word Stress Compass

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / A short unfamiliar text.

Make the natural stress of a lyric audible.

Lead toward the meaning



We sing **together** today

Keep the words around it clear

Keep the surrounding words clear; a meaningful word is not a shouted word.

1. Read the line as ordinary speech and circle its important syllables.
2. Speak it in the musical rhythm, keeping weak syllables clear but lighter.
3. Sing the line and compare whether listeners still hear its natural meaning.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The sung stress supports meaning rather than emphasizing every beat equally.

COMMON TRAP

Shouting the stressed word.

MAKE IT WORK

Clap the stressed syllables before adding all the words.

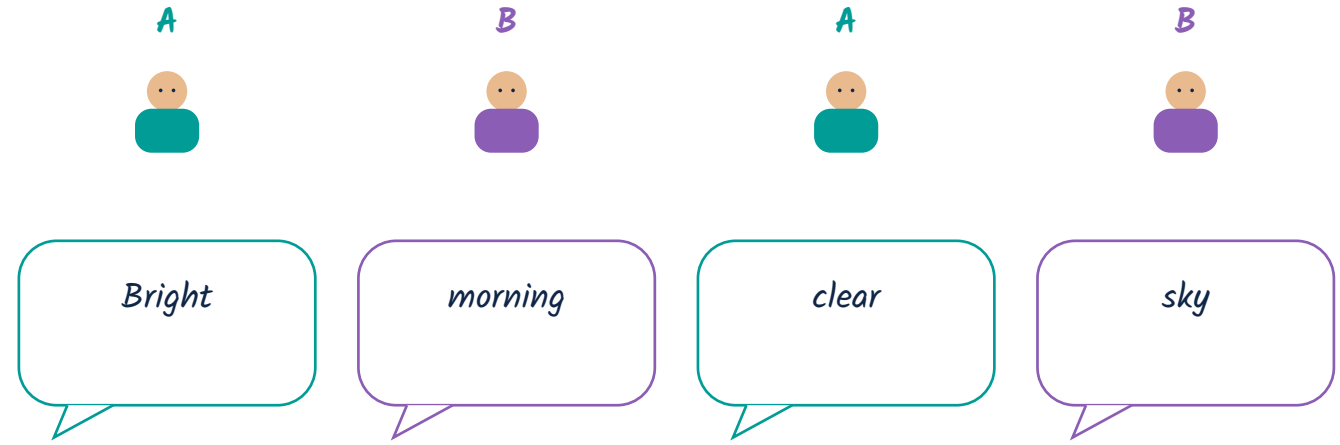
ACTIVITY 040

Text Relay Without Blur

Diction & Articulation

6 minutes / Four short text fragments.

Pass a lyric between groups while keeping words understandable.



Then restore the whole line together

Alternate words between A and B, then restore the line as one choir.

1. Assign one fragment to each group and let them speak it clearly at a moderate tempo.
2. Pass the fragments in order without speeding up or adding gaps between words.
3. Repeat on a shared pitch, then let everyone sing the complete line.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

A listener can write down the whole line accurately after the relay.

COMMON TRAP

Leaving gaps between the groups' words.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two groups and show the order on paper.

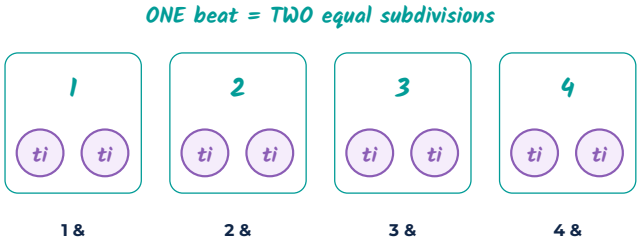
MODULE 05

Rhythm & Pulse

Keep the beat, place the rhythm, and use silence.



Find the Shared Pulse



Two Against the Beat

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

41 Find the Shared Pulse

42 Rhythm Echo Window

43 Speak, Tap, Sing

44 Rest Is an Action

45 Two Against the Beat

46 Accent Swap

47 Walk the Meter

48 Offbeat Entry Builder

49 Tempo Keeper Relay

50 Rhythm Repair Loop

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 041

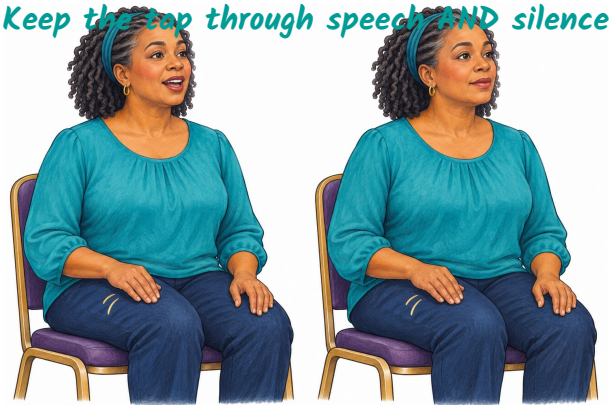
Find the Shared Pulse

Rhythm & Pulse

4 minutes / A short familiar song.

Establish a steady beat before working on rhythm.

Keep the tap through speech AND silence



tap	tap	tap	tap
1	2	3	4

The pulse continues through four silent beats, then the line returns in time.

1. *Tap a gentle beat on the legs while the director sings or speaks the opening line.*
2. *Continue tapping through four silent beats without changing speed.*
3. *Bring the line back and check whether the taps still match its underlying pulse.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The beat continues steadily during silence.

COMMON TRAP

Stopping the internal pulse during silence.

MAKE IT WORK

Use visible hand movements instead of tapping or let singers observe first.

ACTIVITY 042

Rhythm Echo Window

Rhythm & Pulse

5 minutes / Hands or a quiet tapping surface.

Copy a short rhythm after listening to its full shape.

MODEL / LISTEN

ta ta ti-ti ta



RESPONSE / ECHO

ta ta ti-ti ta

wait for cue

Hear the complete four-beat model before the response cue.

1. *Clap four beats containing 'ta ta ti-ti ta'; the choir listens until the full pattern ends.*
2. *Echo the whole pattern once, then compare exactly which beat held two sounds.*
3. *Try two new patterns, keeping the same four-beat listening window.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The response starts after the complete model and preserves its long and short sounds.

COMMON TRAP

Echoing before the complete model has finished.

MAKE IT WORK

Use spoken 'ta' instead of clapping or begin with two-beat patterns.

ACTIVITY 043

Speak, Tap, Sing

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / Two bars from repertoire.

Separate a rhythm problem from its pitch problem.

SPEAK

Say the rhythm

TAP

Keep the beat in your hand

SING

Restore the melody

Keep the same pulse while changing one musical ingredient at a time.

1. Speak the syllable 'ta' in the passage's rhythm while tapping the underlying beat.
2. Speak the actual words with the same rhythm, checking where syllables share a beat.
3. Add the melody at a slower tempo, preserving the spoken rhythm.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Pitch does not make the learned rhythm disappear.

COMMON TRAP

Changing the tempo when adding melody.

MAKE IT WORK

Use only one bar until the coordination is dependable.

ACTIVITY 044

Rest Is an Action

Rhythm & Pulse

4 minutes / Four-beat pattern: sound, rest, sound, sound.

Count a silence actively and enter after it.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS

1	2	3	4
ta	II REST	ta	ta
			
1	*keep counting*	*3*	*4*

Beat 2 is an action: open the hands silently and keep counting.

1

Clap on beats one, three, and four while opening the hands silently on beat two.

2

Repeat using 'loo' on a comfortable note; keep the rest silent rather than inhaling noisily on it.

3

Transfer the silent hand action to a rest in the repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The note after the rest arrives on time without an extra cue.

COMMON TRAP

Treating the rest as an empty extra beat.

MAKE IT WORK

Show four large beat cards and point to the rest.

ACTIVITY 045

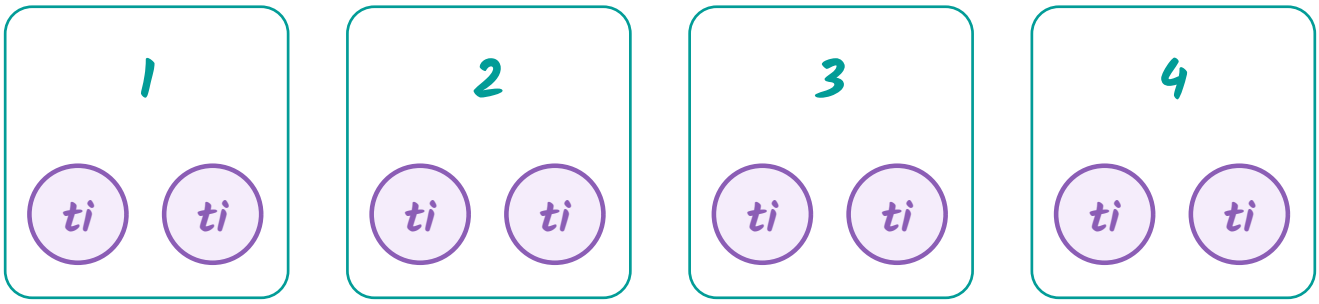
Two Against the Beat

Rhythm & Pulse

5 minutes / A steady moderate pulse.

Feel two equal subdivisions inside one steady beat.

ONE beat = TWO equal subdivisions



1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

Two equal sounds inside each beat; the four large beats do not get faster.

1. *Tap four even beats with one hand and speak 'ti-ti' twice within each beat.*
2. *Alternate one sound per beat with two sounds per beat without changing the underlying tempo.*
3. *Speak a lyric passage that contains both note values, then add its pitches.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Paired sounds divide each beat evenly instead of accelerating.

COMMON TRAP

Speeding up the large beat when subdividing.

MAKE IT WORK

The director taps while the choir only speaks; combine actions later.

ACTIVITY 046

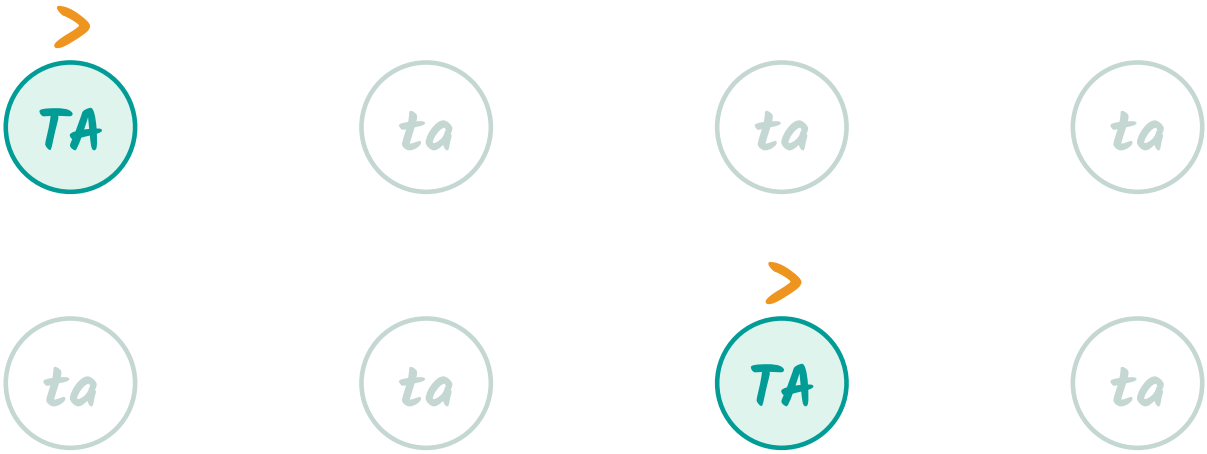
Accent Swap

Rhythm & Pulse

5 minutes / Four repeated spoken syllables.

Distinguish beat placement from musical emphasis.

Same tempo. A different emphasis.



Move the emphasis from beat 1 to beat 3 while keeping the spacing unchanged.

1

Speak four steady 'ta' syllables and gently emphasize the first without making it harsh.

2

Move the emphasis to beat three while keeping the beat equally spaced.

3

Find the accented word in a real phrase and practise it without speeding up toward it.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The emphasis changes while the tempo stays stable.

COMMON TRAP

Moving the beat itself with the emphasis.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a hand lift rather than a louder accent.

ACTIVITY 047

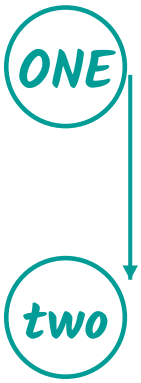
Walk the Meter

Rhythm & Pulse

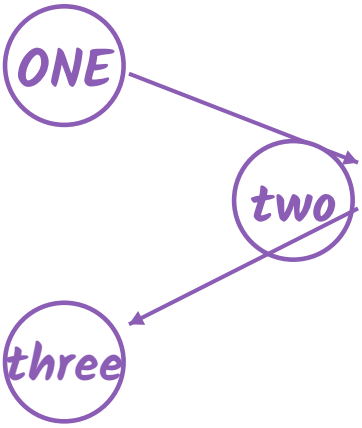
5 minutes / Seated hand movement or clear floor space.

Feel the difference between groups of two and three.

TWO-BEAT GROUP



THREE-BEAT GROUP



Two and three describe beat groupings. Keep every beat evenly spaced.

1. Move one hand down then up for a two-beat grouping while speaking 'ONE two'.
2. Change to down-side-up for 'ONE two three', keeping each beat evenly spaced.
3. Listen to two short musical examples from current repertoire and choose the matching gesture.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group identifies the grouping without confusing it with tempo.

COMMON TRAP

Confusing a different grouping with a faster tempo.

MAKE IT WORK

Use seated gestures only; walking is optional, never required.

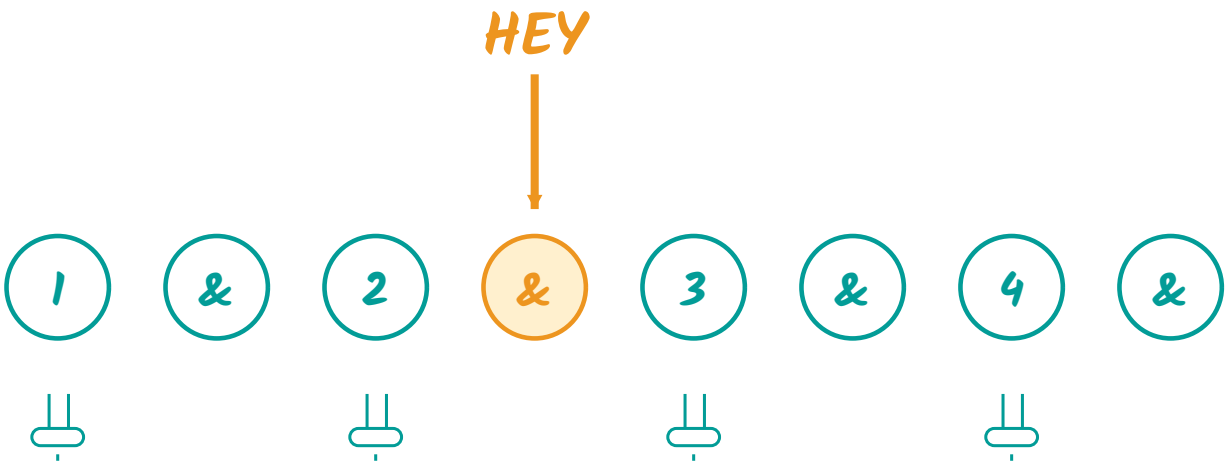
ACTIVITY 048

Offbeat Entry Builder

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / Count '1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and'.

Enter accurately between two steady beats.



Count: 1 and 2 AND 3 and 4 and

Enter on the "and" AFTER beat 2, between the second and third taps.

1. *Tap each numbered beat while the director speaks every number and 'and'.*
2. *Say 'hey' only on the 'and' after beat two, keeping the beat in the hand.*
3. *Repeat with a gentle sung syllable, then apply the same entry point to the song.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir enters between beats instead of waiting for the next downbeat.

COMMON TRAP

Waiting for beat 3 instead of its preceding offbeat.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the spoken count audible until the entrance is secure.

ACTIVITY 049

Tempo Keeper Relay

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / Three willing leaders and a familiar rhythm.

Maintain tempo when leadership changes.

A / 8 BEATS

Keep the pulse

B / 8 BEATS

Take over in time

C / 8 BEATS

Keep the same pace

No gap at a handover. Each new leader inherits the same pace.

1. Leader A taps eight steady beats while everyone follows softly.
2. B takes over without a gap for the next eight, followed by C.
3. Repeat with the choir speaking a lyric and listen for speeding up at each handover.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The handovers preserve the original pace.

COMMON TRAP

Adding a pause when the leader changes.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a metronome only as an optional check, not as the leader.

ACTIVITY 050

Rhythm Repair Loop

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / One trouble spot plus the beat before it.

Practise a difficult rhythm without restarting an entire song.



Isolate, rest, and repeat slowly; then reconnect both joins.

1. Locate the first point where the group loses agreement and isolate only that small section.
2. Loop it three times slowly with a clear starting count and a rest between attempts.
3. Reconnect it to the preceding and following bars; restore speed only after two accurate joins.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The transition remains accurate when surrounding music returns.

COMMON TRAP

Looping without a count-in or recovery gap.

MAKE IT WORK

Use spoken rhythm and remove pitches until the join works.

MODULE 06

Connection & Confidence

Create a welcoming choir that listens and participates.



A NAME OFFERED → A KIND GROUP ECHO

Name and Note Circle



One Helpful Thing

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

51 Name and Note Circle

52 Partner Welcome Question

53 Sound Postcard

54 Echo With Consent

55 One Helpful Thing

56 Common Ground Chorus

57 New Singer Buddy Map

58 Group Signal Agreement

59 Small-Win Closing Circle

60 Listening Seats Exchange

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 051

Name and Note Circle

Connection & Confidence

6 minutes / A circle or seated semicircle.

Learn names while giving everyone a low-pressure first response.



A NAME OFFERED → A KIND GROUP ECHO

An optional name travels into the circle; the whole group echoes it kindly.

1. The director speaks their name over two gentle beats and everyone echoes it.
2. Invite willing singers to offer a spoken name; the group echoes each without judging pitch.
3. Offer an optional one-note sung version, keeping the option to speak or pass.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Everyone is acknowledged, including those who choose not to sing alone.

COMMON TRAP

Calling on an unwilling singer to solo.

MAKE IT WORK

Use name cards and allow a neighbour to introduce someone with permission.

ACTIVITY 052

Partner Welcome Question

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / Pairs with an option to stay in a trio.

Build connection before asking for musical cooperation.



"What song do you enjoy? What helps you rehearse?"

ASK | LISTEN | USE ONE IDEA

Share a partner's answer with the group only with permission.

1. Ask partners to share one song they enjoy and one thing that helps them rehearse.
2. After two minutes, invite volunteers to introduce a partner's preference only with permission.
3. Choose one practical suggestion to use during today's rehearsal.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

At least one useful rehearsal preference is heard and acted on.

COMMON TRAP

Sharing a partner's answer without permission.

MAKE IT WORK

Offer written responses or let singers talk with a familiar partner.

ACTIVITY 053

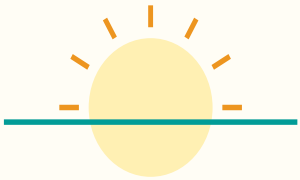
Sound Postcard

Connection & Confidence

6 minutes / Small groups of three or four.

Share a musical idea without a solo-performance test.

A ten-second soundscape / one useful role for everyone



VOICE

BODY SOUND

GESTURE

OBSERVER

A quiet ten-second garden soundscape can include a completely silent role.

1

Each group chooses a place such as a garden or station and invents a quiet ten-second soundscape.

2

Give everyone a role: voice, gentle body sound, gesture, or observer.

3

Groups share once while listeners name something they noticed, without scoring the performance.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Every participant has an agreed role and feedback stays descriptive.

COMMON TRAP

Treating the observer role as less valuable.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep all sounds spoken or unpitched and allow complete silence as a role.

ACTIVITY 054

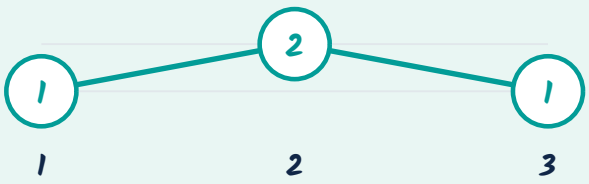
Echo With Consent

Connection & Confidence

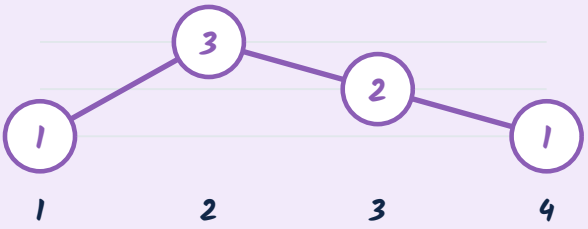
5 minutes / Short three-note model.

Make echo leading inviting rather than compulsory.

OPTION A



OPTION B



Either choice can be useful

A volunteer may sing, point to a pattern, or let the director lead.

1. The director sings a simple pattern and the group echoes together.
2. Invite a volunteer to choose one of two provided patterns to lead, with the director beside them.
3. Thank the leader and return to a full-group response; never call on an unwilling singer.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Volunteers can lead without others being pressured to take a turn.

COMMON TRAP

Calling a volunteer turn compulsory.

MAKE IT WORK

A volunteer may point to a written pattern instead of singing it first.

ACTIVITY 055

One Helpful Thing

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / A brief group performance.

Build useful peer feedback without personal criticism.

FOCUS

Clear final words

OBSERVE

"I noticed the group..."

REPEAT

Keep the useful behaviour

Describe something audible; avoid judgements about someone's voice or talent.

1. Choose one shared focus, such as clear final words, before singing.
2. After the passage, partners describe one specific thing they heard that supported that focus.
3. The choir repeats the passage, keeping the useful behaviour rather than trying to fix everything.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Feedback describes observable musical actions, not talent or personality.

COMMON TRAP

Commenting on talent rather than an audible action.

MAKE IT WORK

Use the sentence 'I noticed the group...' to avoid evaluating an individual voice.

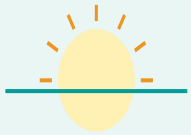
ACTIVITY 056

Common Ground Chorus

Connection & Confidence

6 minutes / A board or large sheet of paper.

Discover shared musical interests across the ensemble.



HOPE



REST



BELONGING



CELEBRATION

Choose one theme / make one original shared line

Choose a shared theme, then make a short original chant without asking for private stories.

1. Collect song themes such as hope, celebration, rest, and belonging rather than requiring personal stories.
2. Ask singers to choose one theme they would enjoy communicating together.
3. Speak a short original line about that theme and create a simple group chant.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir creates a shared musical idea without requiring private disclosure.

COMMON TRAP

Requiring a personal story to choose a theme.

MAKE IT WORK

Offer prepared themes and permit pointing instead of speaking.

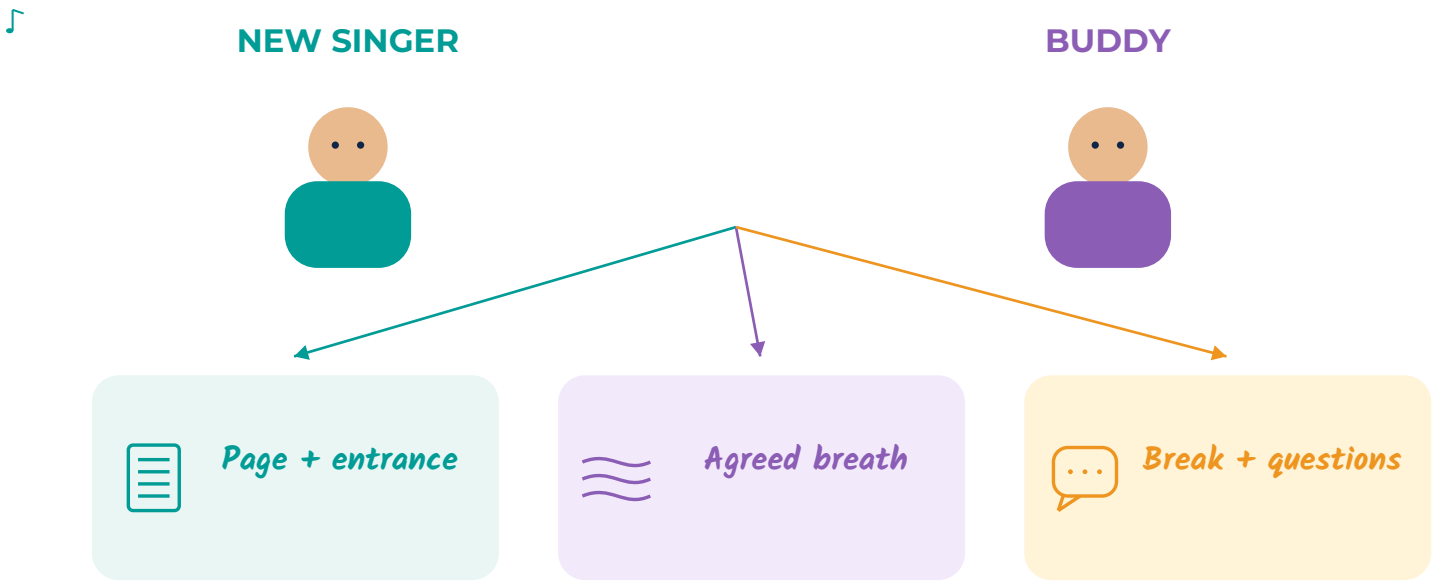
ACTIVITY 057

New Singer Buddy Map

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / Score, seating plan, and a willing buddy.

Give a newcomer practical help without testing them publicly.



A useful welcome answers practical questions: where, when, and whom to ask.

1. Pair a newcomer with someone who can quietly explain page numbers, cues, and breaks.
2. Ask the pair to locate the first entrance and one agreed breath together.
3. Rehearse the opening as a full group, then let the newcomer ask a private practical question.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The newcomer knows where to start, whom to ask, and when to take a break.

COMMON TRAP

Testing a newcomer publicly.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a trio or written orientation card if pairing feels uncomfortable.

ACTIVITY 058

Group Signal Agreement

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / Three simple gestures.

Create clear shared signals that reduce uncertainty.

Demonstrate the actual gestures your choir agrees



READY

Prepare together



REPEAT

Do that unit again



STOP

Release + recover

Agree and demonstrate three distinct gestures. Keep their meanings consistent.

1. *Agree signals for ready, repeat, and stop; demonstrate each without sound.*
2. *Practise responding to a mixed sequence of the gestures with silence or a short spoken response.*
3. *Use all three during a real phrase and ask whether any signal was hard to see.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers can explain and recognize all three signals.

COMMON TRAP

Changing a signal's meaning between rehearsals.

MAKE IT WORK

Pair gestures with words and keep them consistent across rehearsals.

ACTIVITY 059

Small-Win Closing Circle

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / One passage rehearsed today.

End rehearsal with evidence of progress rather than vague praise.

BEFORE

Scattered final t

TODAY'S CHANGE

One agreed release

NEXT REHEARSAL

Keep that release cue

Record one specific improvement and one practical next step.

1. Sing the chosen passage once and remember the specific focus used earlier.
2. Invite short observations beginning 'Today we improved...' with concrete musical details.
3. Choose one achievement to carry into the next rehearsal and write it on the plan.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group names a verifiable change and a practical next step.

COMMON TRAP

Offering praise with no concrete musical example.

MAKE IT WORK

Use anonymous written notes or a shared group response.

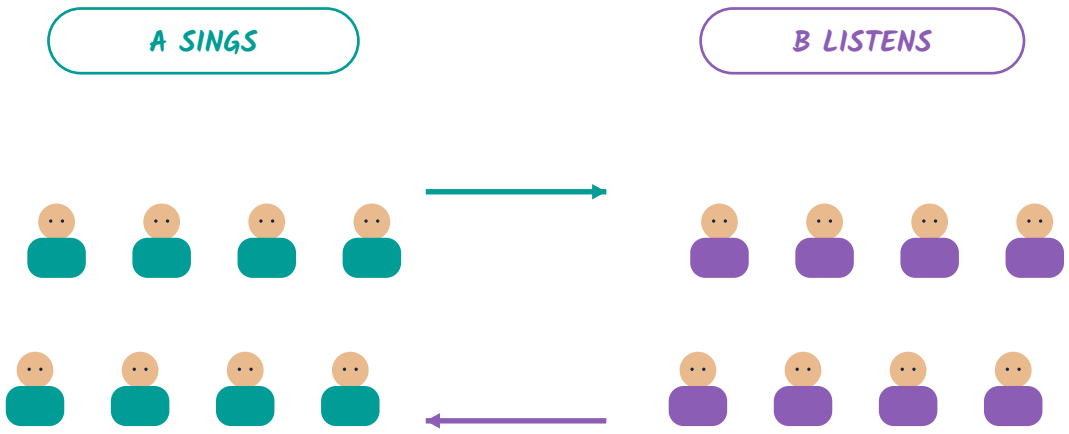
ACTIVITY 060

Listening Seats Exchange

Connection & Confidence

6 minutes / Two groups and a short phrase.

Hear the ensemble from a different perspective without singling out voices.



Swap roles, then sing together

Exchange performer and listener roles. Discuss the ensemble, not individual voices.

1. Group A sings while B listens for one agreed feature, such as aligned endings.
2. B describes what the ensemble did, then the groups exchange roles.
3. Sing together and apply one shared observation; avoid ranking which group sounded better.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listening leads to a specific ensemble adjustment rather than comparison between people.

COMMON TRAP

Ranking groups instead of listening for the focus.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a recording only with permission, or let everyone listen to the director's model.

MODULE 07

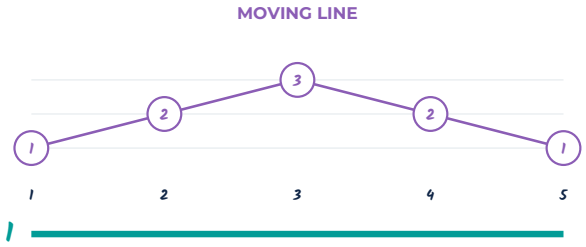
Pitch & Listening

Hear, remember, and coordinate comfortable pitches.



LISTEN FIRST | HUM: TWO BEATS | CHECK THE REFERENCE

One-Note Landing



Drone and Melody

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

61 One-Note Landing

62 Higher, Lower, Same

63 Melody Contour Map

64 Home Note Return

65 Drone and Melody

66 Interval Echo Pairs

67 Find the Different Note

68 Chord Listening Triangle

69 Silent Pitch Recall

70 Tune the Phrase Ending

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

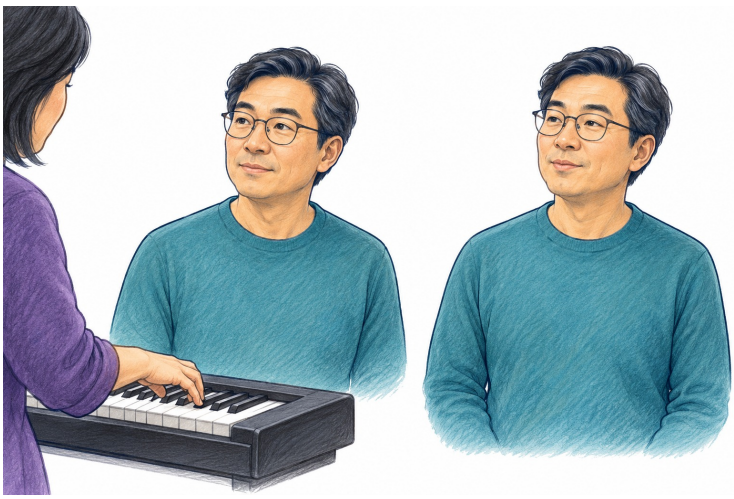
ACTIVITY 061

One-Note Landing

Pitch & Listening

4 minutes / Keyboard, tuning source, or a confident model.

Match a comfortable reference pitch after listening.



LISTEN FIRST | HUM: TWO BEATS | CHECK THE REFERENCE

Listen first; hum for two beats; hear the reference again before "oo".

1. *Play or sing one suitable middle-range note and ask everyone to listen before responding.*
2. *Hum it gently for two beats, stop, and hear the reference again.*
3. *Repeat on 'oo', allowing singers to change octave or listen until they find an easy match.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group returns to the reference rather than drifting away after each attempt.

COMMON TRAP

Starting to sing before hearing the reference.

MAKE IT WORK

Use individual support privately; never ask a singer to push toward an uncomfortable note.

ACTIVITY 062

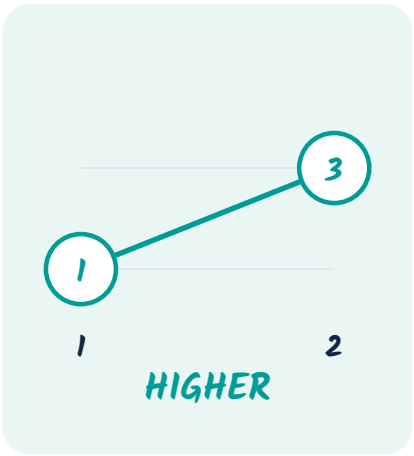
Higher, Lower, Same

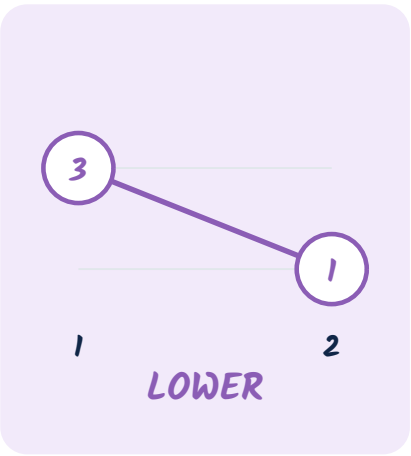
Pitch & Listening

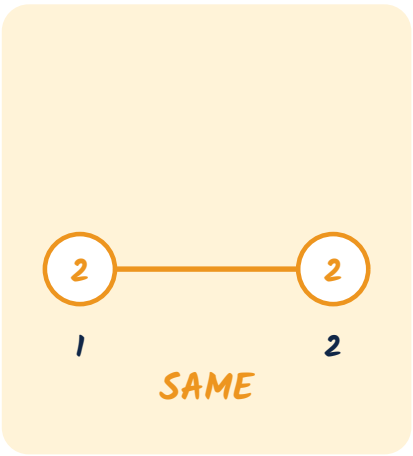
5 minutes / Three hand signs.

Recognize relative pitch direction before reproducing it.

Hear the pair. Show its direction. Then echo.







Identify the direction of each pair before singing it back.

1. *Sing two notes that are higher, lower, or the same; listeners respond with the agreed sign.*
2. *Give six mixed examples in a comfortable range and discuss any uncertain pair.*
3. *Let the choir echo the same pairs on 'loo' after identifying their direction.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group identifies direction before attempting an echo.

COMMON TRAP

Echoing before identifying the direction.

MAKE IT WORK

Use larger pitch differences first; no individual singing is required.

ACTIVITY 063

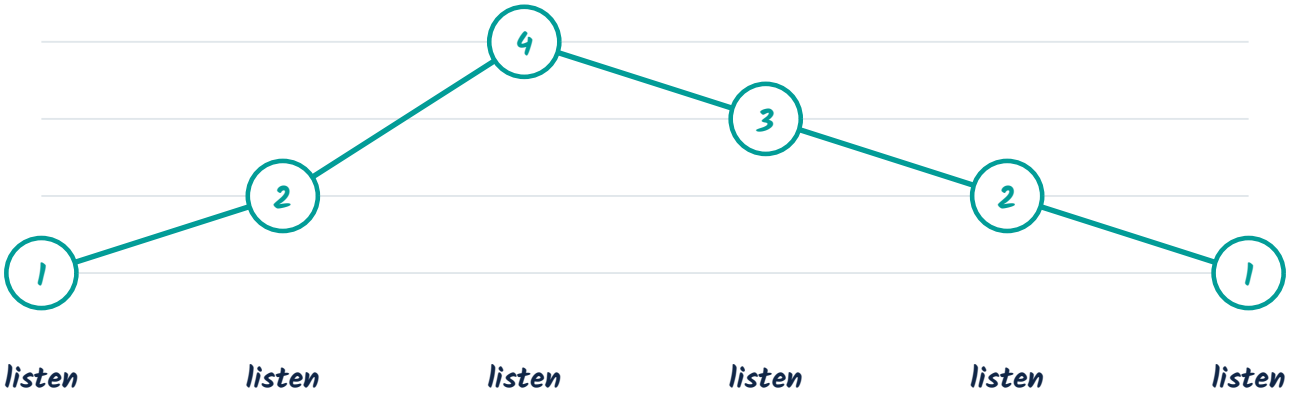
Melody Contour Map

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / Paper and a short phrase.

Connect the shape of a melody to its sound.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



Example contour: rise, turn, fall. Trace the model you actually hear.

1

Listen to a four- to six-note phrase without singing and trace its rise and fall with one hand.

2

Draw a simple line showing the direction changes; compare it with the model.

3

Sing the phrase while following the line, then look away and reproduce it once.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The drawn contour and sung direction agree at each turning point.

COMMON TRAP

Drawing a contour that disagrees with the model.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two- or three-note contour and larger visual gestures.

ACTIVITY 064

Home Note Return

Pitch & Listening

5 minutes / Optional keyboard.

Keep the tonal home in mind during a short pattern.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



The last note is home. Imagine it during the pause before checking the reference.

1. Establish a comfortable home note, then sing 1-2-3-2 and pause.
2. Invite the choir to supply the missing home note before hearing the reference again.
3. Try 1-3-5-3 and return home; rest between attempts and avoid range extremes.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The home note is stable after the intervening notes.

COMMON TRAP

Guessing the home note before imagining it.

MAKE IT WORK

Stay with 1-2-1 and let the director give the final note when needed.

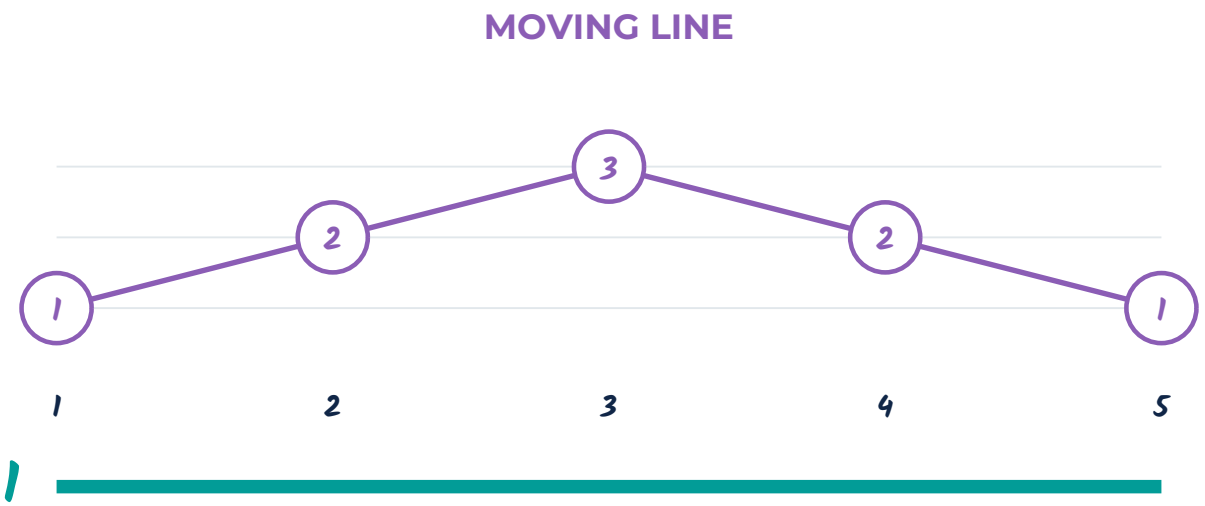
ACTIVITY 065

Drone and Melody

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / Two groups and a short stepwise pattern.

Hear a melody against a quiet sustained reference.



GROUP A: gentle home note

A gentle home note supports the moving line; both groups stop and recover.

1. Group A sustains a gentle home note for four beats while B sings 1-2-3-2-1 at a manageable pace.
2. Stop, breathe normally, and exchange roles; nobody must sustain beyond comfort.
3. Ask singers which melody notes felt settled or unsettled against the home sound.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The reference remains soft enough for the moving line to be heard.

COMMON TRAP

Letting the drone cover the moving line.

MAKE IT WORK

The director or a keyboard supplies the drone so all singers can rest freely.

ACTIVITY 066

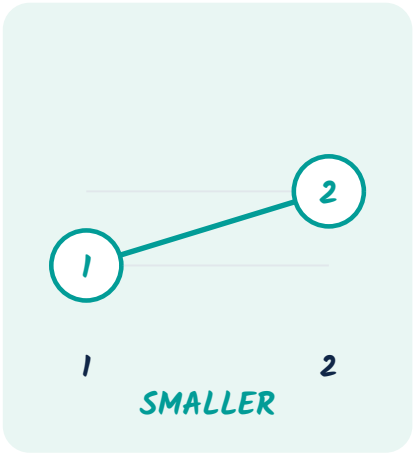
Interval Echo Pairs

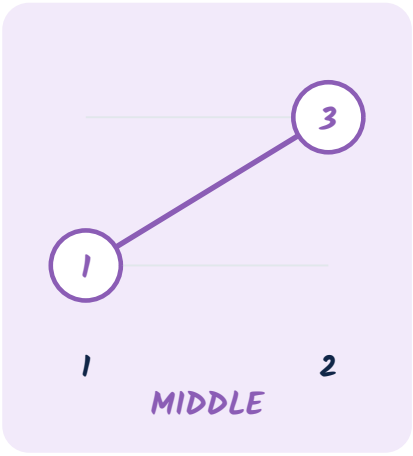
Pitch & Listening

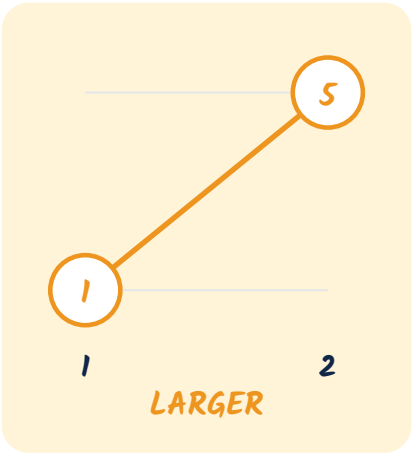
6 minutes / Comfortable two-note models.

Remember the distance between two notes without guessing from text.

Keep the starting note; compare the distance







Same starting note, three different distances. Model each pair before echoing.

1

Model 1-2, 1-3, and 1-5 separately, giving a rest after each pair.

2

Let the group echo and describe whether the distance feels small, medium, or larger.

3

Mix the three examples and then find one matching distance in current repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The response preserves the interval instead of only its general upward direction.

COMMON TRAP

Remembering only that every pair goes upward.

MAKE IT WORK

Use only 1-2 and 1-3 until they are secure; change octave if appropriate.

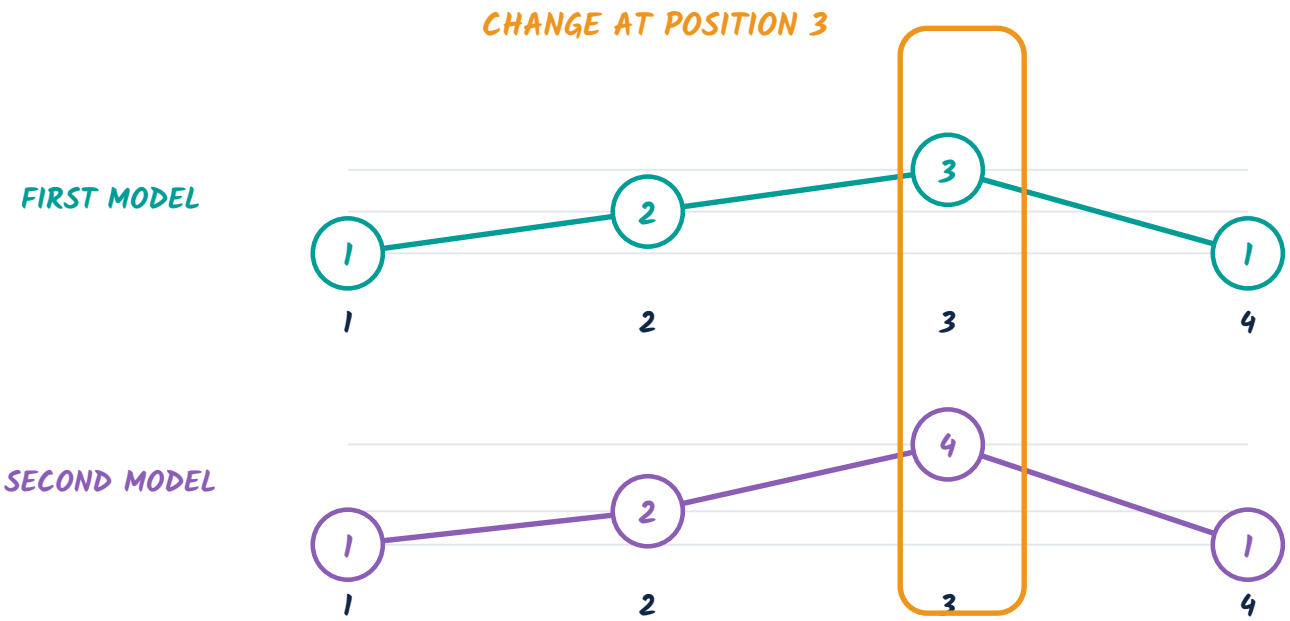
ACTIVITY 067

Find the Different Note

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / A prepared four-note phrase.

Detect a changed pitch by comparing two short versions.



Position 3 changes; the first, second and final notes stay the same.

1

Sing 1-2-3-1 and ask the choir to listen without responding.

2

Sing 1-2-4-1 and let partners identify which position changed, using fingers or words.

3

Rehearse the original, then compare a similar trouble spot in the repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listeners identify the changed position rather than simply saying one version was wrong.

COMMON TRAP

Saying a version was wrong without locating the change.

MAKE IT WORK

Show four blank boxes and point to each note while it sounds.

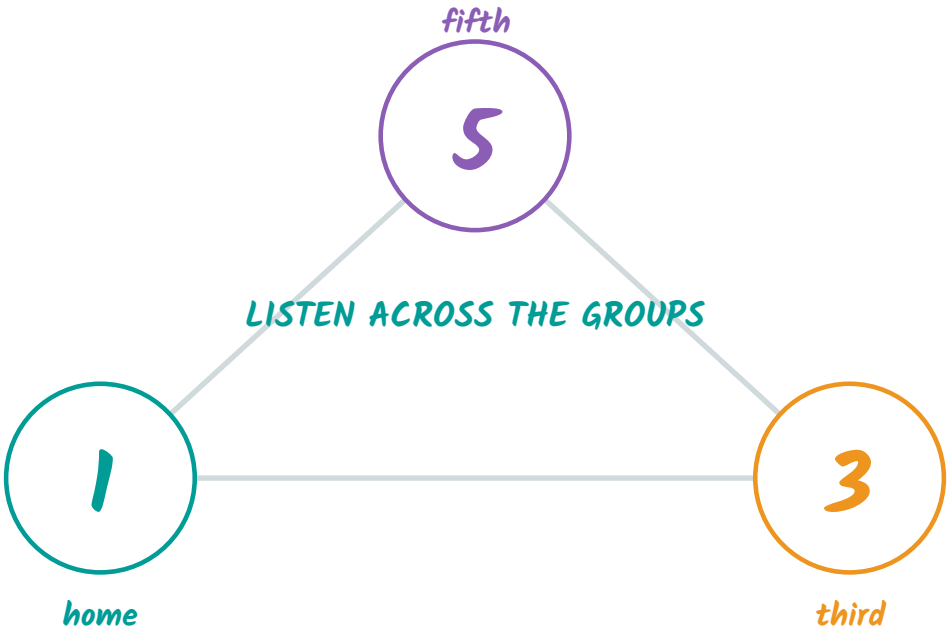
ACTIVITY 068

Chord Listening Triangle

Pitch & Listening

7 minutes / Three groups; optional keyboard.

Balance three chord tones by listening across the ensemble.



Build a comfortable major chord one group at a time, with short holds and normal breaths.

1

Assign home, third, and fifth of a comfortable major chord to three groups and establish each note separately.

2

Build the chord one group at a time at gentle volume, with short holds and normal breaths.

3

Ask the newest group to listen before joining; rotate roles where ranges allow.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers adjust volume so all parts are audible without forcing a perfect blend.

COMMON TRAP

Forcing a fixed chord tone into an unsuitable range.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two notes or let a keyboard provide one part; do not force fixed voice ranges.

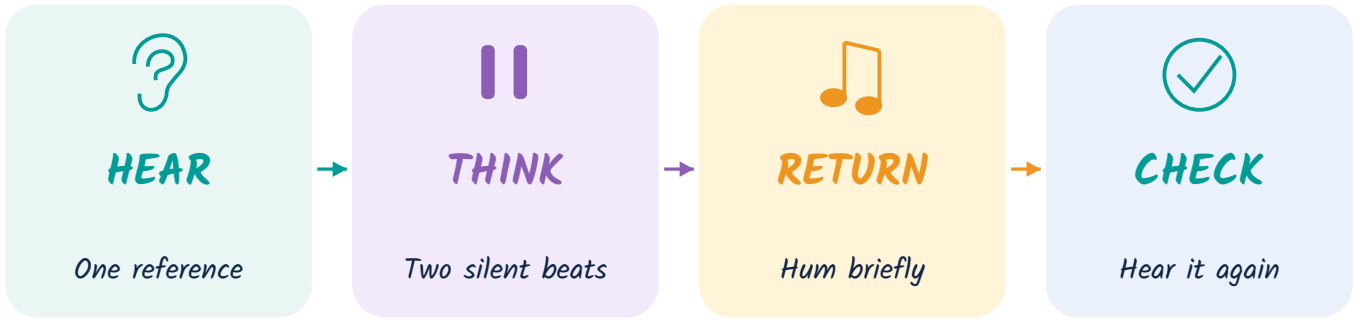
ACTIVITY 069

Silent Pitch Recall

Pitch & Listening

5 minutes / One reference pitch.

Recall a starting pitch after a brief period of silence.



Hear / imagine during two silent beats / return / compare with the reference.

1. Hear a comfortable note, sing it for two beats, then rest for two silent beats.
2. Think the note without humming, then sing it again and compare with the reference.
3. Extend the silent gap to four beats only after the shorter version is reliable.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The returning pitch remains close to the reference without audible rehearsal in the gap.

COMMON TRAP

Audibly rehearsing during the silent gap.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep a very short gap or use a hand sign showing the imagined note.

ACTIVITY 070

Tune the Phrase Ending

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / Last two bars of a song.

Stabilize a closing note within its musical context.

LAST NOTE

Hear the target

→

LAST TWO WORDS

Keep the approach

→

FULL ENDING

Sing it in context

Build the ending backwards in useful units, then test it in the whole phrase.

1. Hear and sing the final note in a comfortable key; notice its place in the phrase.
2. Sing backward from the ending in small units: last word, last two words, then the full closing line.
3. Compare the final pitch to a reference after the complete phrase rather than stopping early to correct it.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The last note is secure when approached through its actual melody.

COMMON TRAP

Securing an isolated final note but never its approach.

MAKE IT WORK

Shorten the phrase and use a slower tempo or octave alternative.

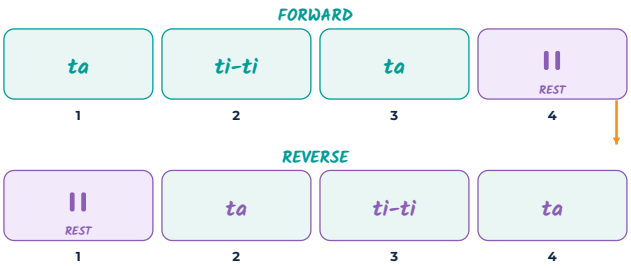
MODULE 08

Focus & Memory

Keep track of cues, words, patterns, and landmarks.



Four-Event Memory Chain



Rhythm Backwards

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

71 Four-Event Memory Chain

72 Missing Word Rehearsal

73 Listen Before You Echo

74 Two Cues, Two Responses

75 Rhythm Backwards

76 Lyric Landmark Map

77 Silent Singing Window

78 Score-to-Eyes Transfer

79 One-Change Challenge

80 Recall and Rebuild

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 071

Four-Event Memory Chain

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / Four cards: clap, tap, speak, rest.

Remember a short sequence of different musical actions.



CLAP | TAP | SPEAK | REST

TURN THE CARDS OVER AND RECALL

? | ? | ? | ?

See the four actions, turn the cards over, then recall the same order.

1. Show a sequence of the four cards and perform it together once at a steady pace.
2. Turn the cards over and repeat the actions in the same order.
3. Reveal the cards to check, then change only one position and repeat the process.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The order stays correct without making the tempo faster.

COMMON TRAP

Changing several card positions at once.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two cards first and allow a partner to point at remembered positions.

ACTIVITY 072

Missing Word Rehearsal

Focus & Memory

6 minutes / One familiar lyric line.

Retrieve important lyric words without depending on the page.

READ	We	sing	together	today
HIDE	We	sing	_____	today
RECALL	We	____	together	_____

Read the complete original line, hide a key word, then retrieve it in rhythm.

1. Read and speak the complete line together, identifying its key words.
2. Hide one key word and let the choir supply it in the spoken rhythm.
3. Hide two words, then sing the full line from memory before checking the original text.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The missing words return in the correct place and order.

COMMON TRAP

Hiding too much text before one word is secure.

MAKE IT WORK

Leave first letters visible or use picture cues for key words.

ACTIVITY 073

Listen Before You Echo

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / Director and a three-note phrase.

Delay the response until the whole model has been heard.

MODEL / LISTEN

1 2 1

RESPONSE / ECHO

1 2 1

wait for cue

A raised hand keeps the group listening. Echo only after the waiting beat and response cue.

1. *Explain that a raised hand means listen and an open palm means echo.*
2. *Model a short phrase while the hand stays raised; release the echo cue after one silent beat.*
3. *Vary the phrase and the waiting beat so the choir cannot simply copy immediately.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

No one starts before the echo cue, even when the model is familiar.

COMMON TRAP

Echoing immediately because the phrase is familiar.

MAKE IT WORK

Use spoken words first and add melody later.

ACTIVITY 074

Two Cues, Two Responses

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / Pointing gesture and open-hand gesture.

Hold two simple musical instructions in working memory.



POINT → Speak "ready"



OPEN HAND → Sing "loo"

Learn one mapping first. After a rest, swap meanings and slow down.

1. Agree that pointing means speak 'ready' and an open hand means sing a gentle 'loo'.
2. Show six mixed cues slowly, allowing one clear response to each.
3. After a rest, swap the meanings and practise again at a slower pace.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir responds to the current rule rather than the previous one.

COMMON TRAP

Swapping meanings before the first rule is secure.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the first mapping throughout for groups who need more processing time.

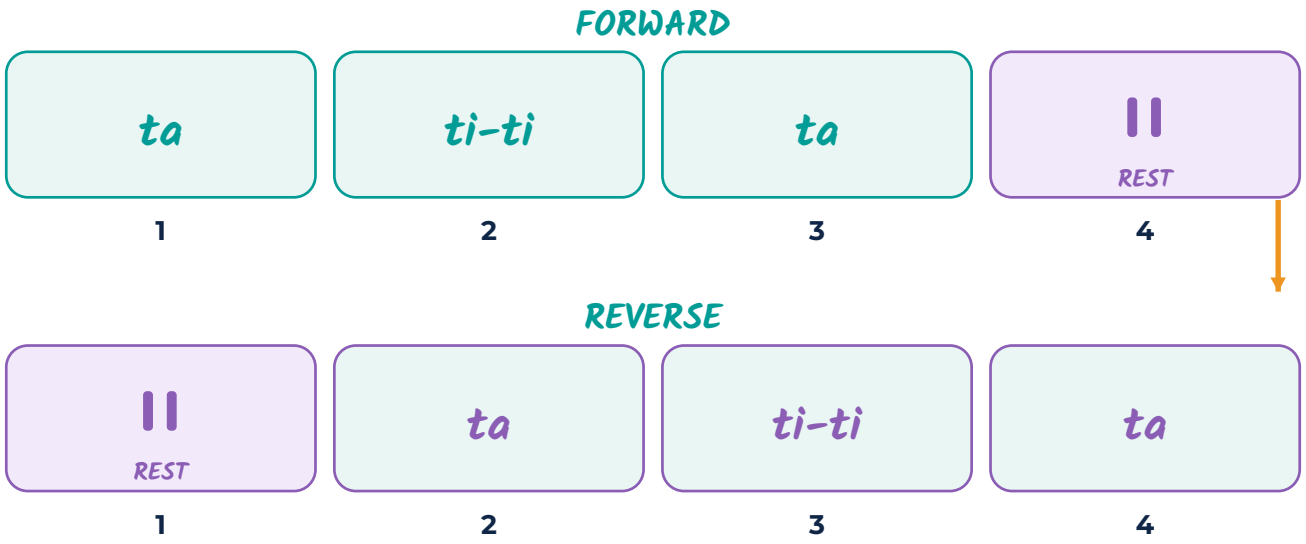
ACTIVITY 075

Rhythm Backwards

Focus & Memory

6 minutes / Four cards with one or two sounds each.

Reorder a short rhythm deliberately rather than by habit.



Reverse the cards, not the two sounds inside "ti-ti".

1. *Show four beats: ta, ti-ti, ta, rest; speak the sequence forward.*
2. *Read the cards from right to left, keeping each card's own sounds unchanged.*
3. *Perform forward then reversed versions, stopping to compare the order rather than racing.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The card order reverses while the internal 'ti-ti' stays together.

COMMON TRAP

Reversing the sounds inside a ti-ti card.

MAKE IT WORK

Use three cards and point through them while the group responds.

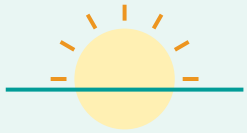
ACTIVITY 076

Lyric Landmark Map

Focus & Memory

7 minutes / Text of one song.

Recall a longer song through meaningful section cues.



VERSE / sunrise



REFRAIN / together



VERSE / path

One meaningful cue for each real section

Illustrative landmarks: choose your own meaningful word for each real section.

1. Choose one memorable word or image for each section and write them in order.
2. Sing section openings while looking only at that landmark list.
3. Remove one landmark at a time and check the text after the attempt, correcting gently.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers can find the next section without restarting the whole song.

COMMON TRAP

Using section cues that mean nothing to the singers.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the full list visible and practise only two sections today.

ACTIVITY 077

Silent Singing Window

Focus & Memory

5 minutes / A well-known four-bar phrase.

Keep the musical sequence moving during a brief silent passage.



The musical sequence keeps moving

Bars 1–2 aloud, bar 3 in the mind, bar 4 aloud in the correct place.

1. Sing the first two bars aloud at an easy tempo.
2. Continue the next bar silently in your mind while watching the beat, then sing the final bar aloud.
3. Check whether both pitch and text rejoin in the right place; shorten the silent section if not.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir returns together at the expected word and note.

COMMON TRAP

Stopping the musical sequence during the silent bar.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep tapping the beat or let the director mouth the text silently.

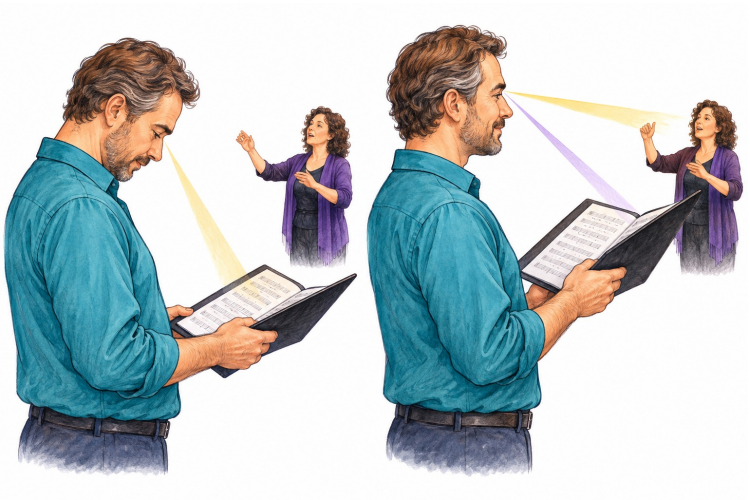
ACTIVITY 078

Score-to-Eyes Transfer

Focus & Memory

6 minutes / One two-bar phrase.

Remember a small unit long enough to watch the director.



READ ONE UNIT

LOOK FOR THE CUE

SING FROM MEMORY

Remember a small unit, look up for its cue, sing, then glance back if needed.

1. Read and sing the first short unit while looking at the score.
2. Look up and sing the same unit from memory, allowing a glance back afterwards.
3. Join two units while planning exactly where it is safe to look up.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Looking up does not cause a lost word or missed entrance.

COMMON TRAP

Looking up before a small unit is remembered.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a one-word unit or a large-print cue card near the director.

ACTIVITY 079

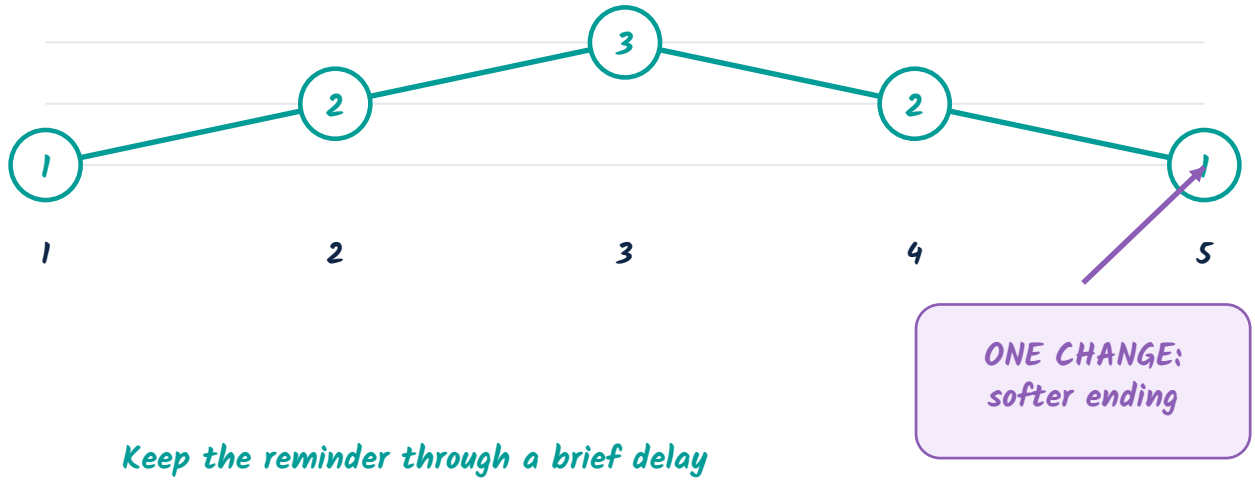
One-Change Challenge

Focus & Memory

6 minutes / One phrase and a written change.

Track a single revision in a familiar passage.

Same notes, words and pulse



Keep the reminder through a brief delay

Change only the ending. Keep notes, words and pulse the same.

1. Sing the phrase as usual, then announce one change such as a softer ending.
2. Repeat with only that change; listeners state whether it happened at the correct place.
3. Write the change into the score and sing again after a brief unrelated task.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The new instruction survives the delay without disturbing other features.

COMMON TRAP

Changing notes, words and dynamics all at once.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the reminder card visible rather than relying on memory alone.

ACTIVITY 080

Recall and Rebuild

Focus & Memory

7 minutes / A familiar song with clear section labels.

Recover a passage after an interruption without starting from the beginning.

STOP
Pause calmly

→

NEXT WORD + NOTE
Find the landmark

→

PREPARE
See the gesture

→

RESTART HERE
Rejoin in time

Restart at an internal landmark instead of returning to the beginning.

1. Stop at a planned point and ask singers to name the next word and starting note quietly to a partner.
2. Give a clear preparation and restart exactly at that point.
3. Repeat from another landmark, then practise the least secure restart once more.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir can restart from at least two internal landmarks.

COMMON TRAP

Restarting the whole song after every interruption.

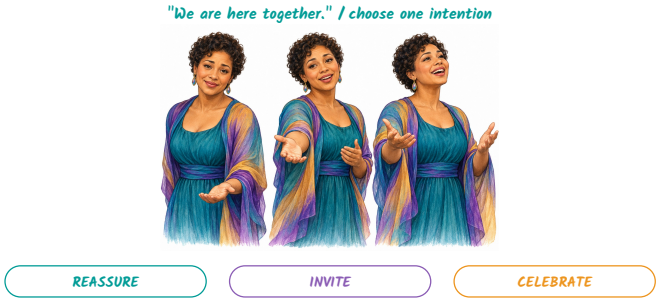
MAKE IT WORK

Supply the starting note and first word before the cue.

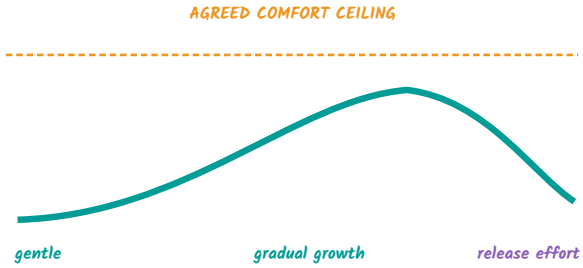
MODULE 09

Expression & Interpretation

Let musical choices communicate the text.



One Phrase, One Intention



Crescendo With a Ceiling

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

81 One Phrase, One Intention

82 Dynamic Staircase

83 Phrase Destination

84 Question and Answer

85 Crescendo With a Ceiling

86 Text Image Gallery

87 Articulation Contrast

88 Emotional Volume Myth

89 Endings That Mean Something

90 Listener's Story Test

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 081

One Phrase, One Intention

Expression & Interpretation

6 minutes / One short lyric line.

Give a lyric a specific communicative purpose.

"We are here together." / choose one intention



REASSURE | INVITE | CELEBRATE

Try one original line with a chosen intention, using musical choices beyond volume.

1. *Read the line and choose one intention, such as reassuring, inviting, or celebrating.*
2. *Speak it to an imaginary listener without changing the words.*
3. *Sing it and let listeners describe which musical choices communicated the intention.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The intention is heard through phrasing, not just a louder voice.

COMMON TRAP

Using louder singing as the only expression tool.

MAKE IT WORK

Offer two intentions to choose from and permit a group response.

ACTIVITY 082

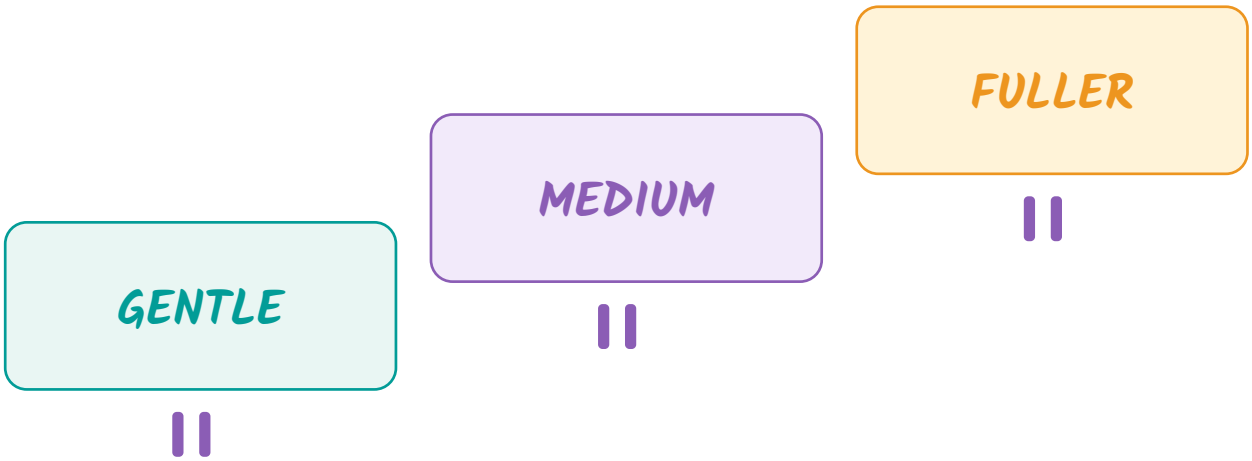
Dynamic Staircase

Expression & Interpretation

5 minutes / Three cards: gentle, medium, fuller.

Make three distinct volume levels without vocal forcing.

Rest between levels; keep the voice comfortable



Three clear levels, with rests. Stop before any singer needs to push.

1. *Sing one comfortable note briefly at a gentle but clear level.*
2. *Repeat at medium and then fuller volume, stopping before any singer needs to push.*
3. *Reverse the order and transfer the three levels to short phrases, keeping a rest between them.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The levels differ clearly while the tone remains comfortable.

COMMON TRAP

Forcing the fullest level to make the steps obvious.

MAKE IT WORK

Use only gentle and medium levels if those cover today's needs.

ACTIVITY 083

Phrase Destination

Expression & Interpretation

6 minutes / A lyric with a clear central word.

Shape a line toward one meaningful word.

Lead toward the meaning



We sing **together** today

Keep the words around it clear

Shape the phrase toward its main word, then let the remaining text release naturally.

1. Read the line and agree which word carries its main message.
2. Sing toward that word with a small sense of direction, then release the remaining text naturally.
3. Compare with a flat version and choose the amount of shaping that fits the style.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The destination is audible without losing the words around it.

COMMON TRAP

Turning the destination word into a hard accent.

MAKE IT WORK

Draw one arrow above the text; avoid treating the target as a shouted accent.

ACTIVITY 084

Question and Answer

Expression & Interpretation

6 minutes / Two adjacent phrases or two original lines.

Give two musical phrases contrasting functions.

"Are you ready?"

"We are ready."



INVITES A RESPONSE



COMPLETES THE IDEA

Question and answer can have contrasting functions without becoming louder.

1

Speak the first line as a question and the second as an answer.

2

Sing both on a comfortable shared note, noticing direction and punctuation.

3

Return to their melody and preserve the conversational relationship between the phrases.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listeners can tell which phrase invites a response and which completes it.

COMMON TRAP

Changing the words instead of their function.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 'Are you ready?' and 'We are ready' before repertoire.

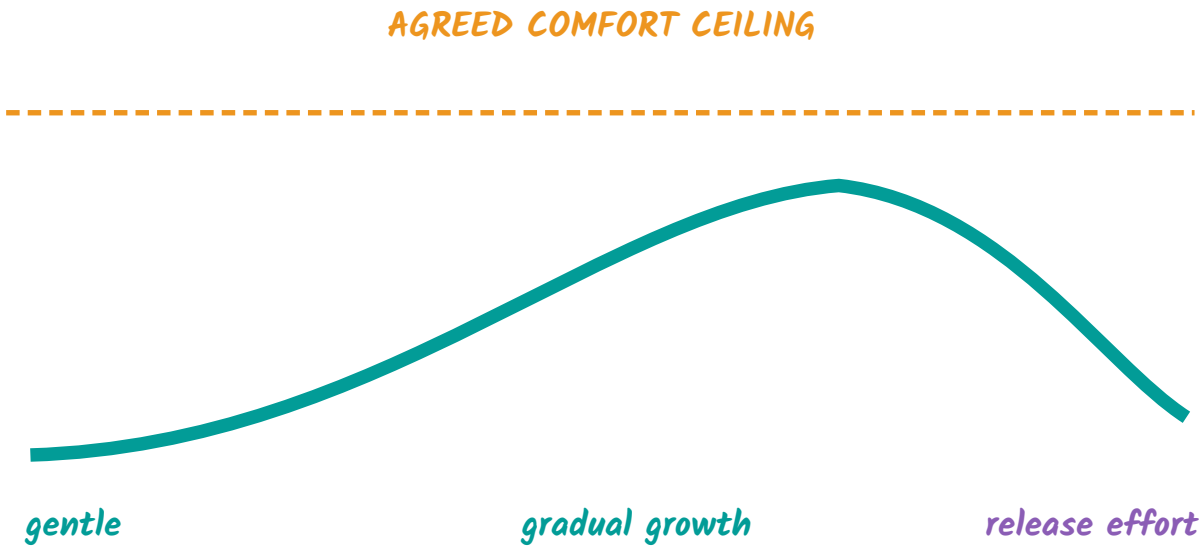
ACTIVITY 085

Crescendo With a Ceiling

Expression & Interpretation

6 minutes / Four-beat sustained note or short phrase.

Increase intensity gradually within a comfortable volume range.



Agree the comfortable ceiling first. Grow gradually and remain below it.

1. Agree a comfortable upper volume before starting; this is the ceiling, not a challenge.
2. Begin gently and increase a little over four beats without exceeding that level.
3. Repeat with a four-beat decrease, then use the shape in repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The change is gradual and stops before the tone becomes forced.

COMMON TRAP

Letting a crescendo become a loudness challenge.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-level change or let singers stay at medium while listening.

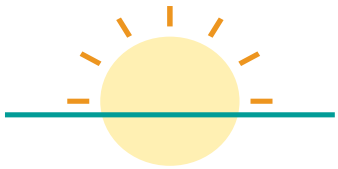
ACTIVITY 086

Text Image Gallery

Expression & Interpretation

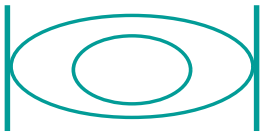
7 minutes / Three simple images or written scene descriptions.

Use a concrete image to clarify a lyric's meaning.



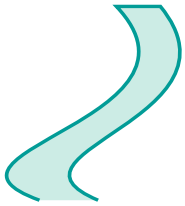
SUNRISE

beginning



SHARED MEAL

sharing



QUIET PATH

calm

An image must serve the actual lyric

Choose an image that clarifies the actual lyric: sunrise, shared meal, or quiet path.

1. *Offer a sunrise, a shared meal, and a quiet path as possible images for a selected line.*
2. *Small groups choose one and explain how it relates to the actual words.*
3. *Sing the line using that image, then name a specific phrasing choice it encouraged.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The image supports the text rather than replacing its meaning.

COMMON TRAP

Choosing an image that replaces the text's meaning.

MAKE IT WORK

Use verbal scene descriptions rather than pictures when visuals are inaccessible.

ACTIVITY 087

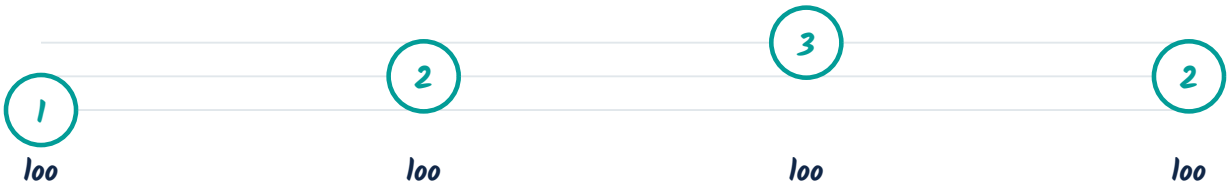
Articulation Contrast

Expression & Interpretation

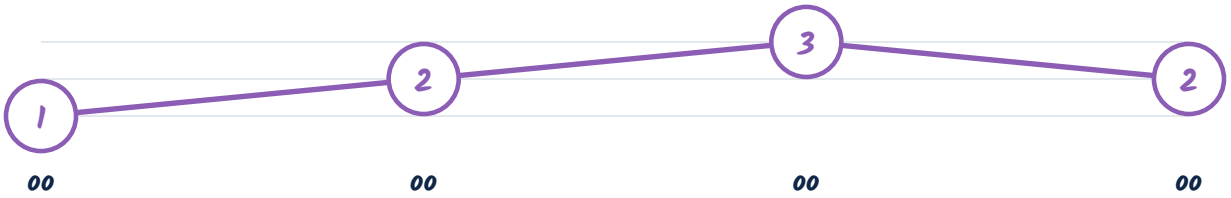
5 minutes / A four-note phrase.

Choose between connected and separated delivery intentionally.

SEPARATE SYLLABLES



ONE CONNECTED LINE



Same notes and pulse: choose a connected or gently separated delivery for a reason.

1

Sing the phrase smoothly on 'loo', then repeat with gently separated syllables.

2

Describe how the two versions change its character while keeping tempo and pitch the same.

3

Apply the version that suits the text and style, then explain the choice.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The selected articulation is consistent across the ensemble.

COMMON TRAP

Changing tempo while comparing articulation.

MAKE IT WORK

Use spoken syllables if singing both versions becomes tiring.

ACTIVITY 088

Emotional Volume Myth

Expression & Interpretation

6 minutes / One expressive lyric line.

Communicate a strong feeling without assuming louder is better.

DICTION

Clear a word

TIMING

Allow a pause

PHRASE DIRECTION

Lead to a word

Three expressive tools at a moderate volume. Choose one that communicates the feeling.

1. Choose a feeling such as wonder or reassurance and speak the words in a natural voice.
2. Sing at a moderate volume, changing diction, timing, or phrase direction to communicate it.
3. Ask listeners which detail carried the feeling; compare two gentle interpretations.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listeners identify expressive details beyond volume.

COMMON TRAP

Assuming a strong feeling needs a loud voice.

MAKE IT WORK

Use an ensemble discussion rather than individual demonstrations.

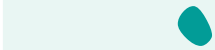
ACTIVITY 089

Endings That Mean Something

Expression & Interpretation

6 minutes / Three lines ending with different punctuation.

Match the end of a phrase to its punctuation and message.



statement



question



exclamation

Plan the ending to fit the sentence

Plan the vowel, final consonant and release so the ending supports the sentence.

1. Speak one statement, one question, and one exclamation without changing their printed words.
2. Sing each on a short pattern and plan its final vowel, consonant, and release.
3. Transfer the appropriate ending to repertoire and compare the effect on the whole line.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ending supports the sentence rather than simply becoming quieter by habit.

COMMON TRAP

Making every ending fade by habit.

MAKE IT WORK

Work with one type of ending per rehearsal.

ACTIVITY 090

Listener's Story Test

Expression & Interpretation

7 minutes / A short passage and two listener volunteers.

Check whether an interpretation communicates a clear narrative.

INTENDED MESSAGE

Write one message

LISTENER HEARS

Listen without clues

ONE ADJUSTMENT

Change one musical detail

Keep the intended message from the listeners until after the first performance.

1. *Agree the intended message before the choir sings, but do not tell the listeners yet.*
2. *Sing once and ask listeners to describe what they understood from the text and musical delivery.*
3. *Compare responses with the intended message and adjust one feature before repeating.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The second performance communicates the agreed message more clearly.

COMMON TRAP

Telling the listeners the answer before they listen.

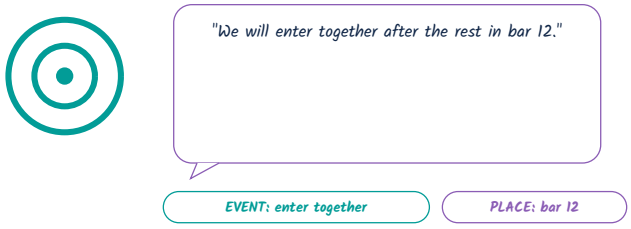
MAKE IT WORK

Use two sections of the choir as listeners and performers.

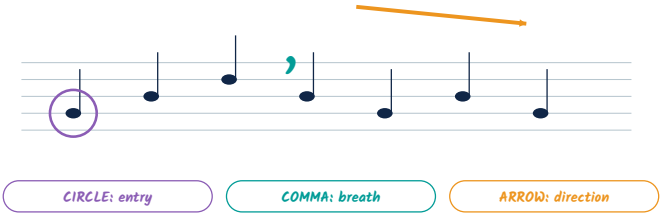
MODULE 10

Rehearsal & Teamwork

Give practice a clear purpose and a useful next step.



Rehearsal Goal in One Sentence



Rehearsal Marking Key

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

91 Rehearsal Goal in One Sentence

92 Trouble Spot Triage

93 Section Handover

94 Three-Pass Repair

95 Rehearsal Marking Key

96 Partner Part Check

97 Balanced Section Entry

98 Transition Without Talk

99 Two-Minute Section Report

100 Next-Rehearsal Bridge

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 091

Rehearsal Goal in One Sentence

Rehearsal & Teamwork

5 minutes / Board or a visible note.

Give the group a clear, achievable target for the session.



"We will enter together after the rest in bar 12."

EVENT: enter together

PLACE: bar 12

A useful target names a musical event you can hear and a place you can find.

1. State one observable target, such as 'We will enter together after the rest in bar twelve'.
2. Let singers locate that point and describe what success would sound like.
3. Rehearse it briefly, then revisit the target near the end and record whether it was met.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group can describe the target and hear whether it happened.

COMMON TRAP

Choosing a target too vague to check.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a spoken target and repeat it before the relevant passage.

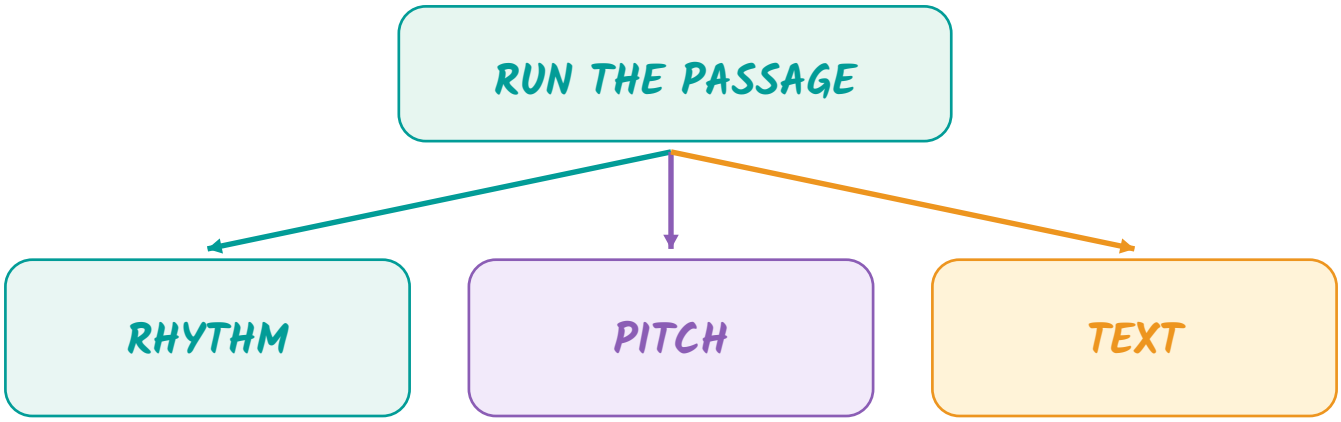
ACTIVITY 092

Trouble Spot Triage

Rehearsal & Teamwork

7 minutes / A short run of current repertoire.

Choose a useful rehearsal priority instead of correcting everything.



Choose ONE blocker / repair / hear the whole passage again

Choose the issue that blocks progress, repair it, then test the full passage.

1. Sing the passage once while the director notes issues without interrupting.
2. Choose one issue that affects the most singers or prevents progress, separating rhythm, pitch, and text.
3. Work on that issue for three minutes, then repeat the original passage to judge the change.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The chosen fix improves the full passage when it returns.

COMMON TRAP

Correcting every issue at once.

MAKE IT WORK

Ask section leaders for one observation each, not a list of complaints.

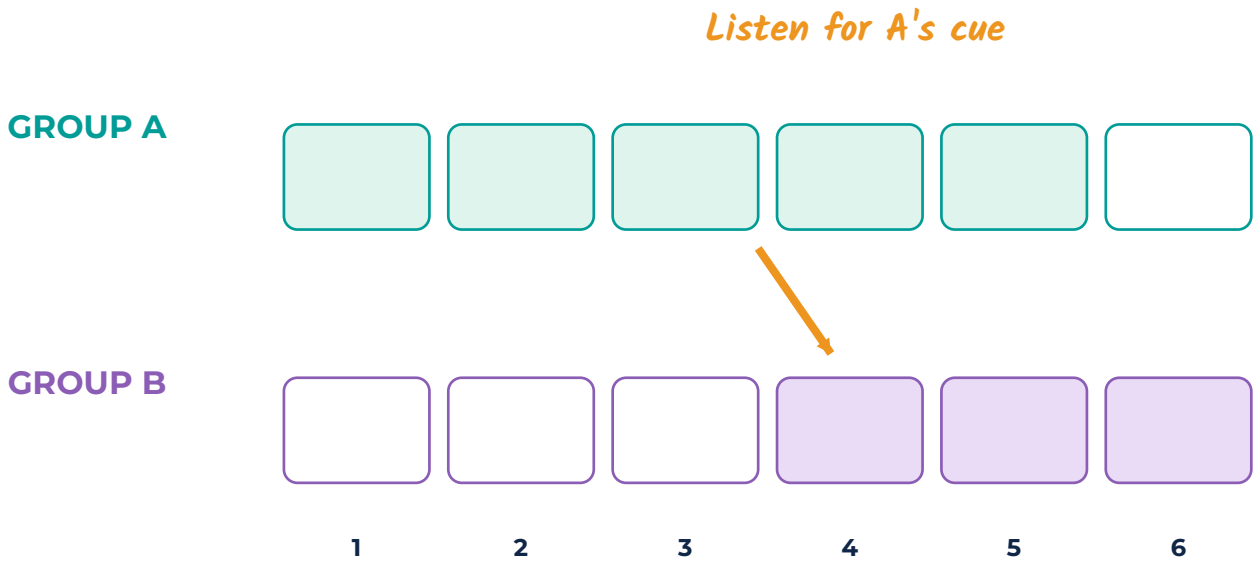
ACTIVITY 093

Section Handover

Rehearsal & Teamwork

6 minutes / Two adjacent entries in repertoire.

Coordinate an entrance that follows another section's phrase.



A's final word is B's listening cue. B also watches the director before entering.

1

Group A sings its last two bars while B listens for the exact cue word or note.

2

B speaks its first words on time, then adds the melody after the timing is secure.

3

Join both parts and ask B to watch the director as well as listening to A.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

B enters confidently without covering A's final word.

COMMON TRAP

Listening to the previous part but missing the conductor.

MAKE IT WORK

The director models A's cue while B practises alone.

ACTIVITY 094

Three-Pass Repair

Rehearsal & Teamwork

7 minutes / A four-bar passage.

Use successive repetitions for different purposes.

PASS 1 / RHYTHM

Speak the rhythm

PASS 2 / NOTES

Sing notes on one vowel

PASS 3 / TEXT

Restore the words

Each pass has a distinct purpose. Restore the complete phrase after the repair.

1. Pass one isolates rhythm in speech, with pitches temporarily removed.
2. Pass two restores notes on one vowel, checking the part without text pressure.
3. Pass three restores words and expression; stop afterwards to name which pass solved the issue.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Each repetition has a distinct purpose that carries into the complete version.

COMMON TRAP

Repeating three times with no distinct purpose.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two bars and repeat a pass only if its specific aim remains unmet.

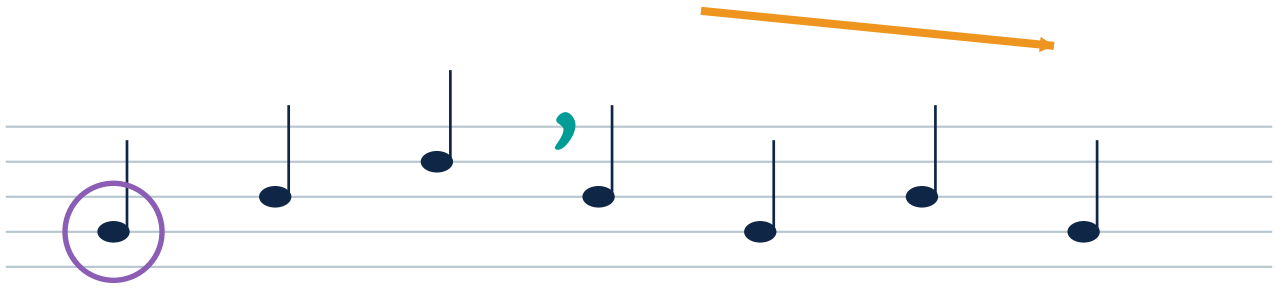
ACTIVITY 095

Rehearsal Marking Key

Rehearsal & Teamwork

6 minutes / Pencils and a short shared symbol list.

Make score annotations clear enough to use next week.



CIRCLE: entry

COMMA: breath

ARROW: direction

Three agreed marks: breath comma, entry circle, and phrase-direction arrow.

1. Agree three marks: a comma for a breath, a circle for an entry, and an arrow for a phrase destination.

2. Mark one example of each in the same passage and check that everyone can locate them.

3. Sing the passage while following the marks; remove or revise any that cause confusion.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers understand their own marks after the verbal explanation ends.

COMMON TRAP

Adding marks nobody can explain next week.

MAKE IT WORK

Offer a printed marked copy or an accessible written description.

ACTIVITY 096

Partner Part Check

Rehearsal & Teamwork

7 minutes / Pairs from the same section.

Hear a part accurately without turning peers into judges.

PERFORM ONE BAR **FOLLOW ONE FEATURE**



Ask the director when a note is uncertain

Swap roles

One bar, one feature, then swap roles. Confirm uncertain notes with the director.

1

Give partners one specific task, such as checking the rhythm of a single bar.

2

Singer A performs the bar or speaks its rhythm while B follows the score; exchange roles.

3

Discuss only that feature and confirm uncertain notes with the director rather than guessing.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Partners return with a concrete question or confirmed correction.

COMMON TRAP

Letting partners guess an uncertain note.

MAKE IT WORK

Both partners may sing together first or ask the director to demonstrate.

ACTIVITY 097

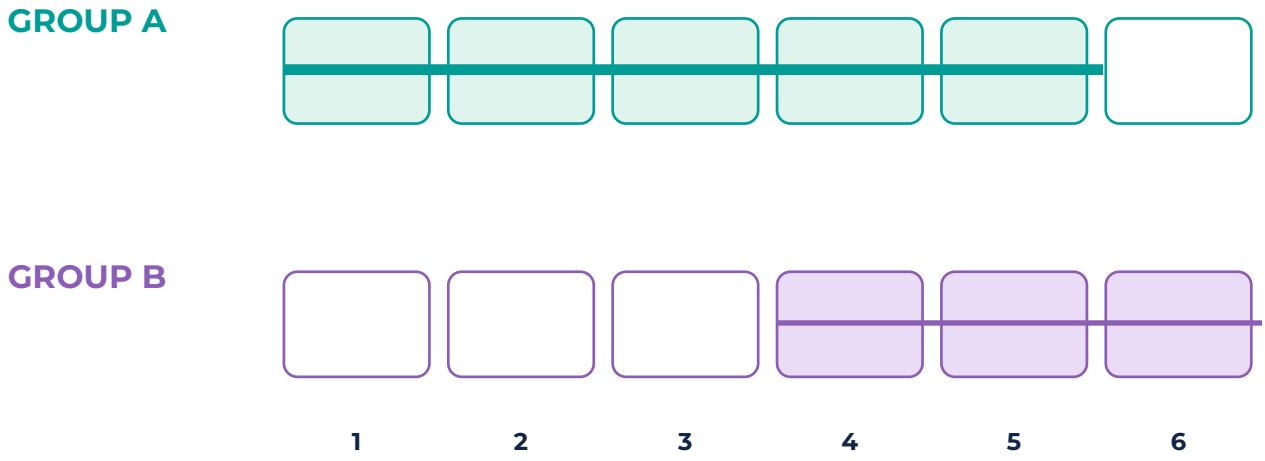
Balanced Section Entry

Rehearsal & Teamwork

6 minutes / Two overlapping parts.

Keep a new section from overpowering a continuing line.

New entry: clear, but gentler



Let the entering section be clear without covering the continuing words.

1. *Let the continuing group sing its line alone so everyone hears its shape.*
2. *Add the entering group at a gentler volume and listen for the continuing text.*
3. *Adjust balance once and sing both parts again, preserving the new entry's clarity.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Both the new entry and the continuing words remain audible.

COMMON TRAP

Making the entry clearer by covering the ongoing line.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two small mixed groups if the choir has no fixed sections.

ACTIVITY 098

Transition Without Talk

Rehearsal & Teamwork

6 minutes / Two planned rehearsal tasks.

Move between activities with clear instructions and little lost time.

PAGE	STARTING PLACE	FIRST ACTION
Page 4	Bar 12	Speak the first line

Give all three before ending the current task, then allow ten quiet seconds to find the place.

1. Before ending task one, state the next page, starting point, and first action.
2. Give ten quiet seconds to find the place, then check readiness with a visible signal.
3. Begin task two promptly and ask whether anyone lacked a needed instruction.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The next task starts without repeated questions about where or how to begin.

COMMON TRAP

Naming the page but omitting the starting action.

MAKE IT WORK

Project the next page number and speak it twice when needed.

ACTIVITY 099

Two-Minute Section Report

Rehearsal & Teamwork

7 minutes / A short section task.

Turn section work into useful information for the full choir.

SOLUTION

What worked?

BAR NUMBER

Where exactly?

NEXT QUESTION

What should we test?

A useful section report leads to a test in the full ensemble.

1. Give each section one passage and one question to solve in three minutes.
2. Ask a spokesperson to report the solution, remaining difficulty, and exact bar number in under a minute.
3. Reassemble and test the reported solution in context rather than accepting it without listening.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Reports lead to one clear action in the full ensemble.

COMMON TRAP

Giving a report with no bar number or next test.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a written report or let the director visit groups instead.

ACTIVITY 100

Next-Rehearsal Bridge

Rehearsal & Teamwork

5 minutes / Rehearsal notes or a shared board.

Finish with a precise starting point for the next meeting.

TODAY'S GAIN
A steadier rest

→

PAGE + BAR
Page 4, bar 12

→

ONE HOME TASK
Speak the rhythm slowly

→

NEXT START
Test the re-entry

Keep the next rehearsal connected to one precise preparation request.

1. Name the strongest improvement from today's final run and the next unresolved task.
2. Write its page, bar, and one requested preparation action, such as speaking a rhythm slowly.
3. At the next rehearsal, begin with that point and check whether the preparation helped.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The next meeting begins with continuity rather than repeating the whole diagnosis.

COMMON TRAP

Ending with an unclear request to practise more.

MAKE IT WORK

Provide the instruction on paper; do not require an app or home instrument.

MODULE II

Performance Preparation

Prepare the cues, space, sequence, and recovery plan.



WALK THE ROUTE → SETTLE + SEE THE CUE

Walk-On and Settle

FINAL RELEASE
Finish together

→ QUIET PAGE CHANGE
Find the next page

→ STARTING NOTE
Listen quietly

→ NEW CUE
Wait for preparation

Between-Song Reset

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

101 Walk-On and Settle

102 First Ten Seconds

103 Microphone Distance Check

104 Audience Focus Points

105 Between-Song Reset

106 Mistake Recovery Anchor

107 Acoustic Listening Pass

108 Dress Rehearsal Checklist Run

109 Final Consonant to Stillness

110 Performance Debrief That Helps

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 101

Walk-On and Settle

Performance Preparation

7 minutes / Clear route and marked places.

Enter the performance space safely and become ready together.



WALK THE ROUTE → SETTLE + SEE THE CUE

Walk the route slowly first. Mark steps, cables, access and a clear view of the director.

1. Walk the planned route slowly, checking steps, cables, and access needs before singing.
2. Arrive at places, face the director, and allow a quiet moment to settle without a rigid pose.
3. Repeat the route and add only the opening preparation gesture, keeping the route unhurried.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Everyone reaches a usable place with a clear view before the cue.

COMMON TRAP

Adding singing before the route is safe and usable.

MAKE IT WORK

Rehearse seated arrival or an alternative accessible route individually.

ACTIVITY 102

First Ten Seconds

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Opening note and first phrase.

Make the beginning of a performance predictable.

READY → **EYE CONTACT** → **PREPARATION** → **FIRST SOUND**

READY	EYE CONTACT	PREPARATION	FIRST SOUND
Find support	See the hand	Ordinary breath	Enter together

Practise this beginning after different lengths of silence.

1. Practise the silent sequence: ready position, eye contact, preparation, and entrance.
2. Add the opening phrase once, then stop and reset rather than continuing the whole song.
3. Repeat with a longer audience-like pause so singers learn to wait for the cue.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group starts together even after an unfamiliar pause.

COMMON TRAP

Starting the phrase before everyone sees the cue.

MAKE IT WORK

Supply the starting note immediately before every attempt.

ACTIVITY 103

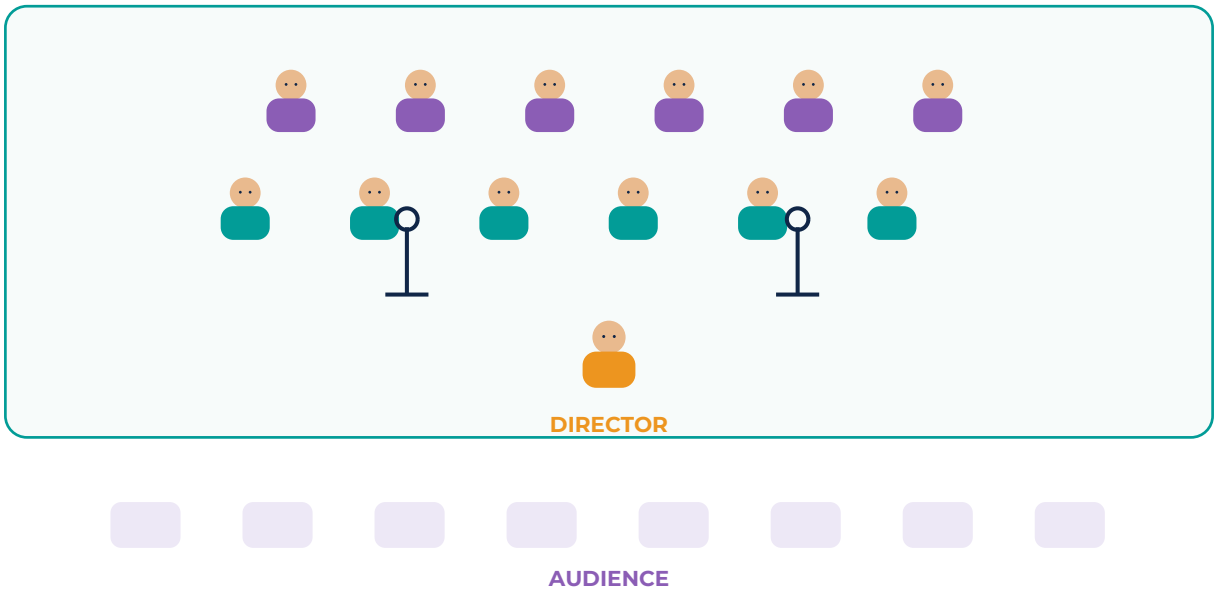
Microphone Distance Check

Performance Preparation

8 minutes / Performance microphone and sound operator, if available.

Find a practical amplified setup without singing louder to compensate.

Test normal singing with the sound operator



Test positions with the sound operator and a normal singing voice; no fixed distance suits every setup.

1. Ask the operator to set a safe working level while the choir sings a short representative phrase normally.
2. Try the planned positions without blocking faces or access routes; do not handle equipment without permission.
3. Repeat the phrase and agree which position gives clear sound without forcing; note the setup for the event.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The setup supports normal singing and clear visibility.

COMMON TRAP

Compensating for a microphone problem by singing harder.

MAKE IT WORK

If no microphone is available, map the intended positions and discuss the soundcheck plan.

ACTIVITY 104

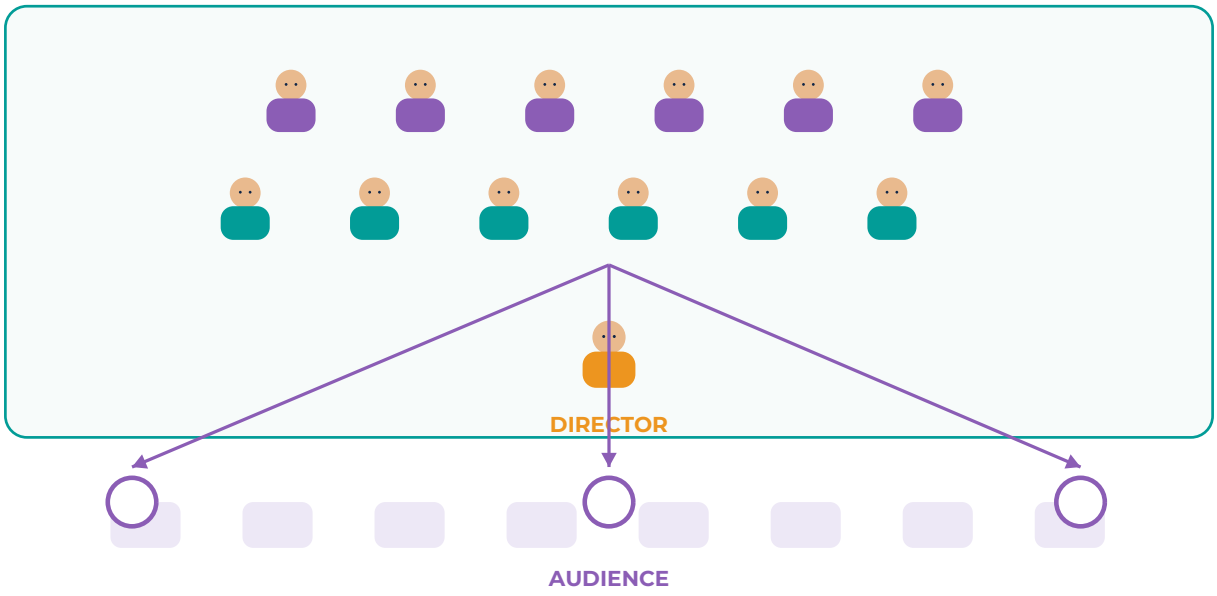
Audience Focus Points

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Three safe visual points in the room.

Look outward without losing contact with the director.

Return to the director for important cues



Plan brief outward moments, then return to the director for important cues.

1. Choose a centre point and two side points above audience eye level; keep the director visible.
2. Speak a line while allowing the eyes to reach the centre point, then return for the cue.
3. Sing the phrase, choosing planned outward moments rather than scanning continuously.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers communicate outward while still seeing important cues.

COMMON TRAP

Scanning the room continuously and losing the director.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep eyes on the director throughout if additional focus changes are distracting.

ACTIVITY 105

Between-Song Reset

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Two pieces and a clear order.

Handle the silence between pieces without confusion.

FINAL RELEASE
Finish together

→

QUIET PAGE CHANGE
Find the next page

→

STARTING NOTE
Listen quietly

→

NEW CUE
Wait for preparation

The next preparation waits until the group has found its place.

1. Rehearse the end of song one, including its release and the director's acknowledgement.
2. Change pages or positions during an agreed quiet interval; check that nobody is left behind.
3. Hear the next starting note and prepare only when the director gives the new cue.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The next piece begins without rustling through the preparation gesture.

COMMON TRAP

Turning pages through the preparation gesture.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a printed running order and larger page tabs.

ACTIVITY 106

Mistake Recovery Anchor

Performance Preparation

7 minutes / A familiar passage with clear bar numbers.

Continue after a slip using a planned musical landmark.

LANDMARK A → PLANNED SLIP → LANDMARK B



Listen and find B's word + note

After a planned slip: listen, find the director, then rejoin at the next agreed landmark.

1. *Choose two safe re-entry landmarks and confirm the starting words and notes for each.*
2. *The director briefly stops one group at a planned point while the others continue.*
3. *That group listens and rejoins at the next agreed landmark; discuss the route without blame.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

A slip does not force the ensemble to restart the piece.

COMMON TRAP

Scrambling to catch every lost note after a slip.

MAKE IT WORK

Practise with spoken text first and supply a clear visual cue at re-entry.

ACTIVITY 107

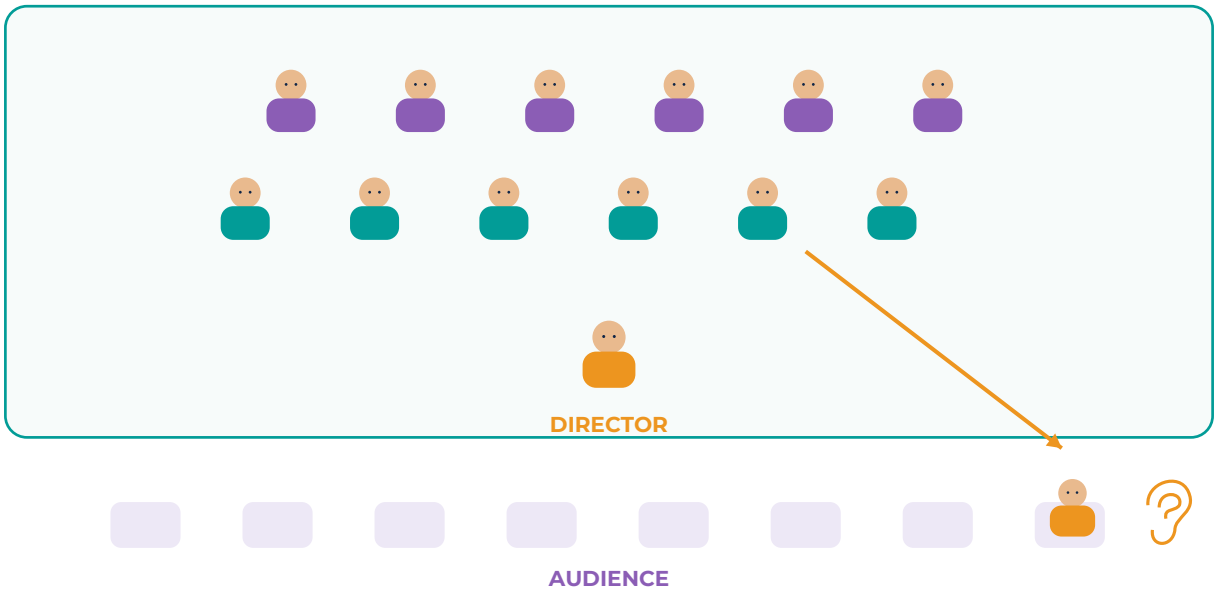
Acoustic Listening Pass

Performance Preparation

8 minutes / Performance space or a different rehearsal position.

Adapt balance to a room before changing vocal effort.

Hear the room from an audience position



A listener in the audience checks text and balance. Adjust the setup before asking for more effort.

1. *Sing a short passage at normal volume while a listener stands where the audience will sit.*
2. *Ask about text clarity, balance, and room resonance rather than whether it is 'loud enough'.*
3. *Change spacing, articulation, or tempo slightly and test again, keeping the voice comfortable.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

A practical room adjustment improves clarity without asking the choir to push.

COMMON TRAP

Asking only whether the room sounds loud enough.

MAKE IT WORK

Record only with permission; otherwise use one trusted listener.

ACTIVITY 108

Dress Rehearsal Checklist Run

Performance Preparation

8 minutes / Folders, music, attire or planned substitutes.

Test practical readiness using a short performance excerpt.

OPENING

Check visibility

PAGE TURN

Test score handling

ENDING

Keep the final cue

Test practical equipment, scores, clothing and access in a short real run.

1. Check footwear stability, score handling, lighting, and any needed mobility access.
2. Perform one opening, one page turn, and one ending exactly as planned.
3. Write down practical snags and assign someone to resolve each before the event.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Every discovered snag has an owner and a clear next action.

COMMON TRAP

Finding a snag without assigning someone to fix it.

MAKE IT WORK

Use substitute clothing or props if full attire is unavailable.

ACTIVITY 109

Final Consonant to Stillness

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Final phrase of a song.

Finish a piece with coordinated sound and a calm visible ending.

COORDINATED ENDING

vowel	vowel	vowel	consonant
1	2	3	4



release

two attentive silent beats

Final vowel / agreed consonant / release / two attentive silent beats.

1. Agree when the final vowel, consonant, and conductor release occur.
2. Sing the ending, then remain comfortably attentive for two silent beats without freezing the body.
3. Follow the director's acknowledgement before changing pages or speaking.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ending is unified and the ensemble does not break attention prematurely.

COMMON TRAP

Holding the breath during the two silent beats.

MAKE IT WORK

Practise only the last word and the two silent beats.

ACTIVITY 110

Performance Debrief That Helps

Performance Preparation

7 minutes / A recent performance or a rehearsal run.

Use a performance experience to choose one constructive improvement.

EVIDENCE

A clear first entrance

ONE CHALLENGE

A rushed page change

ONE ACTION

Rehearse that transition

Name the exact musical moment, choose a task, and schedule the next test.

1. Ask the choir to name one musical success supported by a concrete example.
2. Choose one challenge the group can influence, locating the exact moment rather than blaming a person.
3. Agree one rehearsal action and schedule where to test it next time.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The debrief ends with a specific, achievable rehearsal task.

COMMON TRAP

Blaming a person instead of choosing a useful action.

MAKE IT WORK

Collect written observations and discuss them as group themes.

MODULE 12

Creativity & Inspiration

Create bounded musical ideas with a practical purpose.





Your idea:



LISTEN + REST BEFORE THE REPLY

Four-Note Composer

Call-and-Response Maker

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

111 Four-Note Composer

112 Rhythm Name Mosaic

113 Lyric Seed Workshop

114 Sound and Silence Sculpture

115 Call-and-Response Maker

116 Style Choice Laboratory

117 Rehearsal Inspiration Cards

118 Community Dedication Line

119 Arrange a Gentle Ostinato

120 Choir's Own Closing Ritual

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY III

Four-Note Composer

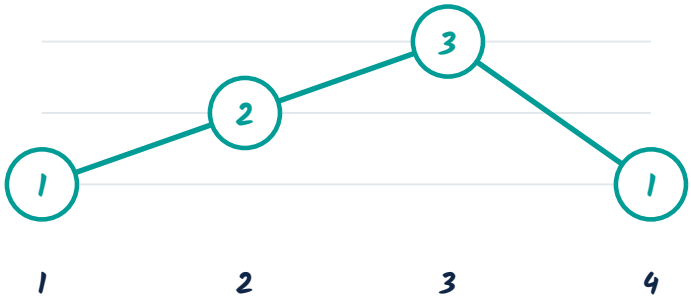
Creativity & Inspiration

7 minutes / Four beats and notes 1, 2, and 3.

Create a short melody within a clear musical boundary.



One note per beat / notes 1, 2 and 3



Your idea:

One original example: four beats, one note per beat, using only notes 1, 2 and 3.

1. Model a four-beat phrase using only the three notes, with one note per beat.
2. Pairs invent a different phrase, choosing a comfortable starting pitch and allowing a rest.
3. Share voluntarily, echo the phrase, and describe its shape rather than ranking it.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The created phrase fits four beats and uses the agreed note set.

COMMON TRAP

Using more notes or beats than the agreed boundary.

MAKE IT WORK

Speak note numbers or use hand signs instead of singing alone.

ACTIVITY 112

Rhythm Name Mosaic

Creativity & Inspiration

7 minutes / Name cards or voluntary spoken names.

Build an original group rhythm from spoken names.

SAM	MAYA	LEO
Sam	Ma ya	Le o

1	2	3	4
Sam	Ma-ya	Le-o	II REST

Original name-card example, used with permission. Hear syllables over a repeating beat.

1. Choose three names with permission and speak their natural syllable rhythms.
2. Arrange them across a short repeating pulse, inserting a rest where needed.
3. Perform the combined rhythm together, then replace names with neutral syllables while keeping its shape.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The mosaic has a repeatable rhythm and clear rests.

COMMON TRAP

Forcing someone to offer a personal name.

MAKE IT WORK

Use favourite food or place names instead of personal names.

ACTIVITY 113

Lyric Seed Workshop

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / Theme cards and paper.

Write a brief original lyric that fits a simple rhythm.

THEME: BELONGING

To-geth-er we sing here

SIX SYLLABLES OVER FOUR BEATS

To-ge	ther-we	sing	here
1	2	3	4

An original six-syllable line can begin with two syllables on beats 1 and 2.

1. Choose a shared theme such as belonging and collect a few concrete words.
2. Write a line of six to eight syllables, checking that its meaning is clear when spoken.
3. Speak it over four beats and revise awkward words before trying a gentle melody.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The lyric can be spoken naturally within the chosen pulse.

COMMON TRAP

Fitting awkward words before speaking the line naturally.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a sentence starter such as 'Together we...' and work as one group.

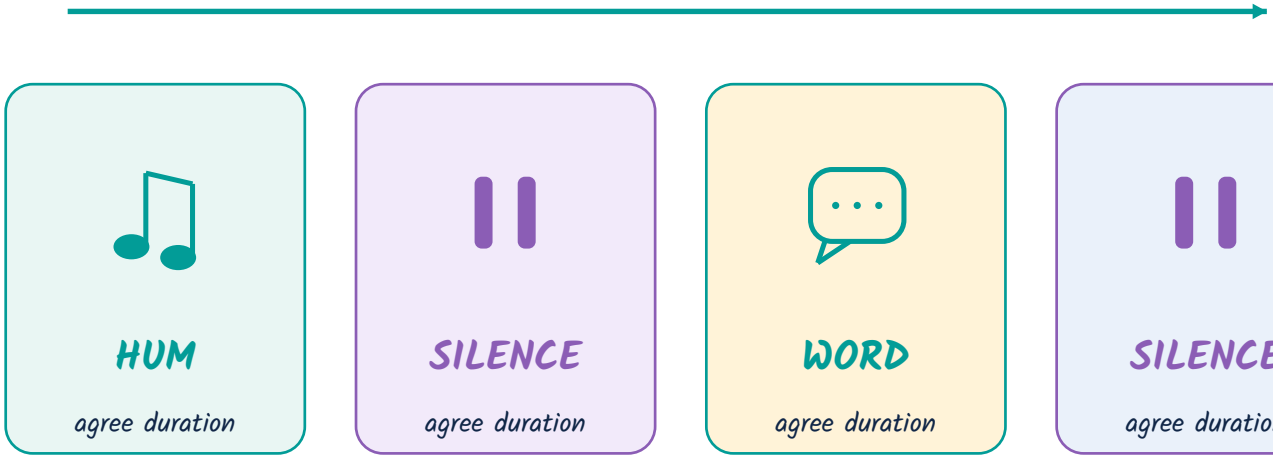
ACTIVITY 114

Sound and Silence Sculpture

Creativity & Inspiration

7 minutes / A visible four-box plan.

Make a short structured piece using sound and intentional rests.



Four agreed durations make a repeatable form. Silence has a deliberate place.

1. *Label four boxes: hum, silence, spoken word, silence; agree a comfortable duration for each.*
2. *Perform the plan once with a clear cue at every boundary.*
3. *Let groups change one box and explain how the silence changes the musical effect.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The silences are deliberate and the form can be repeated.

COMMON TRAP

Treating silent boxes as unplanned gaps.

MAKE IT WORK

Use gestures or gentle tapping instead of pitched sound.

ACTIVITY IIS

Call-and-Response Maker

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / A two-bar framework.

Invent a response that clearly answers a short musical call.



LISTEN + REST BEFORE THE REPLY

A short original call and one possible reply. Listen, rest, then answer.

1

The director offers a short original call on notes 1-2-3; the group listens first.

2

Pairs create a reply using 3-2-1 or another easy three-note shape with matching length.

3

Perform the call and selected replies with a rest between turns, keeping participation voluntary.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The response fits the space and relates audibly to the call.

COMMON TRAP

Answering before hearing the complete call.

MAKE IT WORK

Create a spoken reply before setting it to notes.

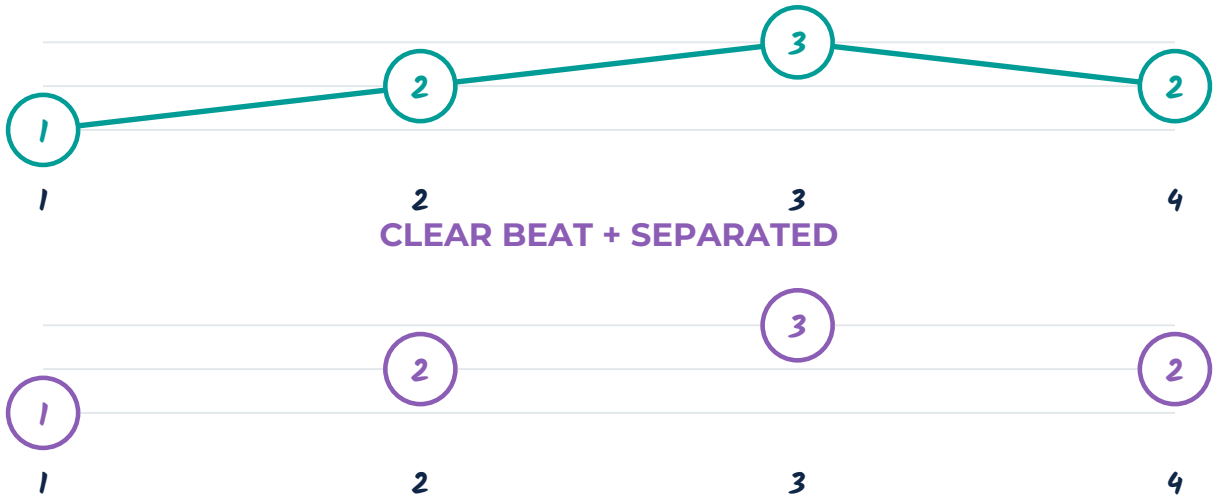
ACTIVITY 116

Style Choice Laboratory

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / A short original or licensed phrase.

Explore how interpretation changes when musical features change.



Change articulation and pulse deliberately; choose what supports the text.

1. *Sing the phrase once with connected notes and a gentle, flowing pulse.*
2. *Repeat with lighter separated articulation and a clearer beat, without imitating a cultural style you have not studied.*
3. *Choose the features that best support the text and name the actual changes made.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers describe concrete musical choices instead of relying on stereotypes.

COMMON TRAP

Naming a cultural style instead of musical features.

MAKE IT WORK

Work in speech and rhythm if the melodic version is too demanding.

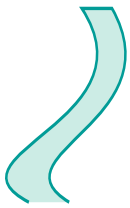
ACTIVITY 117

Rehearsal Inspiration Cards

Creativity & Inspiration

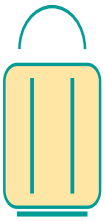
7 minutes / Cards reading river, lantern, bridge, and sunrise.

Turn a creative image into a practical musical experiment.



RIVER

flow



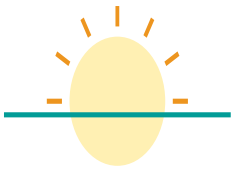
LANTERN

clarity



BRIDGE

connection



SUNRISE

growth

An image must serve the actual lyric

Turn one image into a musical experiment, then judge whether it helps the real phrase.

1. *Pick a card and connect its image to a specific feature: flow, clarity, connection, or gradual growth.*
2. *Sing one phrase using that feature, staying within comfortable vocal limits.*
3. *Ask whether it improved the actual music; keep useful choices and discard distracting ones.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The image produces an audible, relevant adjustment.

COMMON TRAP

Keeping a creative image even when it distracts.

MAKE IT WORK

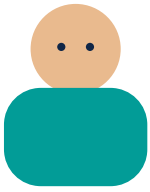
Read the images aloud or let the whole choir choose one card.

Community Dedication Line

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / The next performance's purpose.

Create a short spoken or sung introduction that suits the audience.



"We are glad to share this song with you."



WELCOME / OPENING CUE

An original welcoming example: "We are glad to share this song with you." Keep participation voluntary.

1. Discuss who will listen and what the song can appropriately offer them, avoiding assumptions about beliefs.
2. Write one clear welcoming sentence and test it aloud for length and tone.
3. Choose a speaker or group response voluntarily and rehearse the sentence into the opening cue.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The introduction is concise, respectful, and leads smoothly into the music.

COMMON TRAP

Writing a long introduction that delays the opening.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the dedication spoken and use inclusive language suited to the event.

ACTIVITY 119

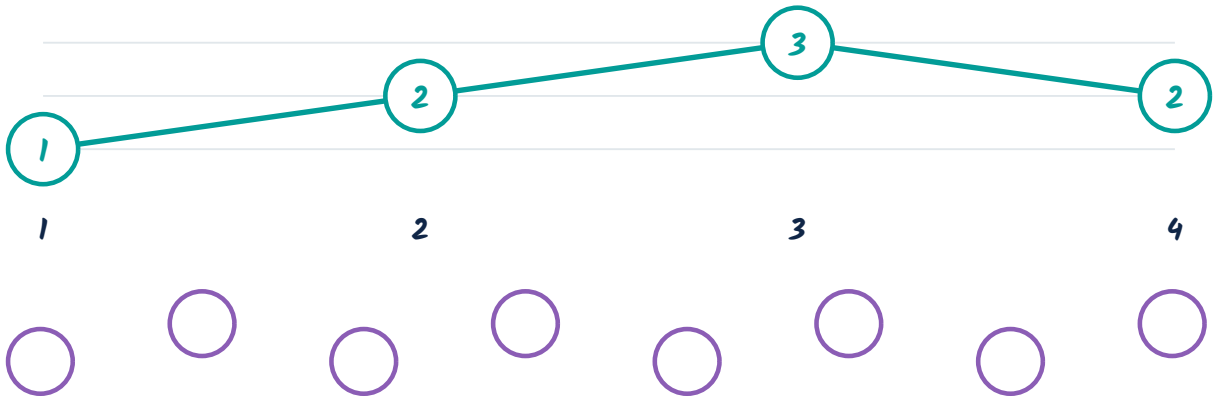
Arrange a Gentle Ostinato

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / An original melody or music you have permission to arrange.

Support a melody with a short repeating pattern.

MELODY: keep the text clear



A gentle two-note pattern below the melody

Illustrative contour only: choose actual accompaniment notes that fit your melody's harmony.

1. Choose a two-note pattern that fits the melody's harmony and comfortable voice ranges.
2. Practise it quietly for four beats, then rest while another group tries the melody.
3. Combine them briefly and reduce the ostinato's volume if it hides the text; check any clashes with the score.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The repeated part supports the melody without overpowering it.

COMMON TRAP

Choosing accompaniment notes without checking harmony.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a rhythmic spoken pattern if harmonic choices are uncertain.

ACTIVITY 120

Choir's Own Closing Ritual

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / Two minutes for group planning.

Create a repeatable musical ending that reflects the ensemble.

"Together, we leave with hope."



One original closing example: a shared word, a brief response, then a clear ending.

1. Collect one word that describes how the choir wants to leave rehearsal, such as grounded or connected.
2. Build a brief original spoken line and a comfortable two-note response around the chosen word.
3. Agree the cue, duration, and option to listen; use the ritual once and review whether it feels welcoming.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ritual is short, repeatable, and comfortable for the whole group.

COMMON TRAP

Making a closing ritual compulsory for every voice.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the ritual entirely spoken and allow any singer to pass.

A rehearsal note worth keeping

Date / group

Date: _____ Group: _____

One target

Today we are working on: _____

We will know it is working when: _____

Chosen activities

Activity numbers: _____ Repertoire phrase / bars: _____

What happened?

First attempt: _____

Change made: _____

Result in the full phrase: _____

Next rehearsal

Keep: _____

Next task and starting point: _____

Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

Build a practical weekly sequence

Step 1 / Arrival and purpose

One short body or attention task:

_____

Step 2 / Sound preparation

One comfortable vocal activity:

_____

Step 3 / Today's musical focus

One rhythm, text, pitch, or expression task:

_____

Step 4 / Transfer

The exact repertoire passage where this will help:

_____

Step 5 / Check and close

Observable success criterion:

_____

What to revisit next time:

_____

Pacing reminder

The time plan includes instruction, listening, normal breathing, and recovery. Adjust the length and intensity to the group rather than filling every minute with singing.

Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

Further reading and resource notes

Voice-care reference

National Institute on Deafness and Other Communication Disorders (NIDCD), Taking Care of Your Voice. https://www.nidcd.nih.gov/health/taking-care-your-voice. Consulted October 16, 2026. This source supports the brief general reminders about rest, avoiding strain, and comfortable voice use; it is not the source of the 120 lesson designs.

About the collection

The activities, teaching sequences, sample lines, and planning templates were written for this collection. The illustrated worksheets follow the visual style of the product previews. Illustrated people are decorative, not photographs of contributors.

Your use

Use and print the resources for your own choir leadership, teaching, and internal rehearsals. Do not resell or publicly redistribute the collection. Keep your order confirmation for access and support information.

Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.